

THE

IMPERIAL CULTURE

THOUGHTFULLY CRAFTED

BRAND BOOK

The core manual that defines how the brand operates, looks and communicates: one source of truth uniting strategy, identity and design into a single living system for our living culture kombucha. It is written the way we brew, with patience, restraint and intention.

LIVING CULTURE KOMBUCHA · CRAFTED FOR MODERN WELLNESS

- LIVING CULTURE KOMBUCHA
- MODERN WELLNESS
- EVERYDAY RITUAL
- LIFESTYLE APPEAL

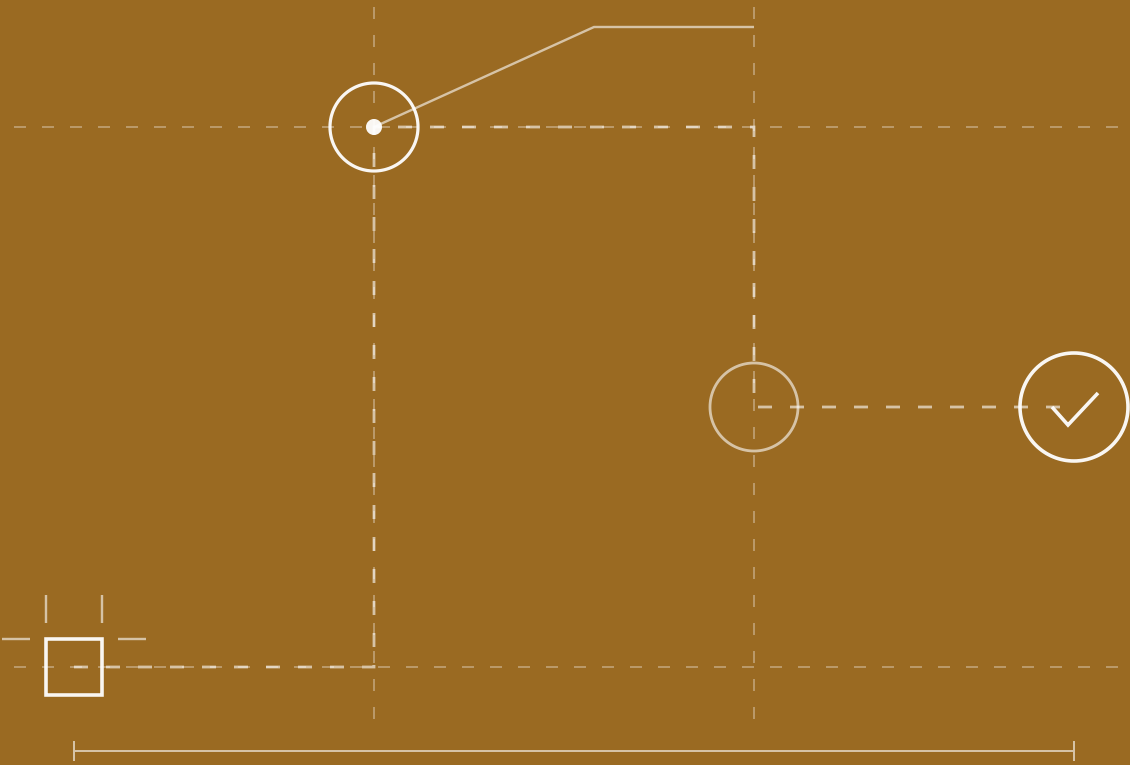
1920 × 1080 | EDITION 1.0

The Imperial Culture Sdn. Bhd.

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NAVIGATION & ALIGNMENT



How this book is ordered, and what it aligns to.

1.0

Master table of contents

FOUR PARTS · EVERY PAGE
READ 1.0 FIRST

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How to use this book

PURPOSE · WHAT THIS BOOK GOVERNS

The brand identity manual for The Imperial Culture:
who we are, what we stand for, and how the brand
is presented consistently at every touchpoint.

Think of it as the single source of truth. When a question about the brand comes up, the answer lives here. Where a page conflicts with a newer approved decision, the record wins and this book is revised. The book is never overruled silently.

THE RULES OF USE

- ✔ Nothing ships off-system: colour, type, spacing and grid come from Visual identity (2.3), never reinvented per artwork
- ✔ The wordmark is never redrawn, recoloured or rebuilt: assets come from Documents (4.1)
- ✔ Confidential: internal teams and authorised partners only, see Terms (1.0) and Legal (4.2)
- ✔ Nothing public without sign-off: the approval path in Governance (4.3) closes every release

READING THIS BOOK · THE SYSTEM IS MODULAR

START WITH STRATEGY

Part 1 to 2.1 explain the thinking. Read them once so every later decision stays anchored.

LEARN THE IDENTITY

Parts 2.2 and 2.3 are the working reference: voice, logo, colour, type and elements.

APPLY WITH CONFIDENCE

Part 3 shows the brand in the real world. Match new work to the closest example.

PROTECT AND APPROVE

Part 4 governs files, legal use, collaboration and sign-off before anything ships.

TERMS & CONDITIONS

IMPORTANT NOTICE

This book is confidential. It circulates to The Imperial Culture staff and authorised partners only, and every copy remains the property of The Imperial Culture Sdn. Bhd. Access ends when a role or engagement ends, and copies are returned or destroyed on request.

OWNERSHIP

The name, marks, colour system, typography and visual signatures belong to The Imperial Culture Sdn. Bhd. The system is governed through the brand custodian. No period of use, however long, transfers any right in the marks or the masters.

ALTERATIONS

Masters are never modified. Refinement requests travel through the approval chain (4.3); a working copy is never the source of truth. When a rule blocks real work, the rule is raised and revised, never quietly bent.

DISTRIBUTION

Files come from Documents (4.1), versioned, via the brand custodian. Forwarded copies and re-exports fall outside the system and are withdrawn. If a file did not come from Documents, it does not speak for the brand.

PERMITTED USE

Use this book to produce on-brand work for The Imperial Culture. Nothing here may be republished, resold or supplied to a third party without sign-off. Work made inside these rules needs no further approval; anything outside them routes through the brand custodian first.

CONFIDENTIALITY

Recipes, unreleased flavours, supplier detail and commercial figures stay out of anything produced from this book. What the brand has not published, the brand does not publish, in any market and on any surface.

CLAIMS

Every health, function and labelling claim clears Legal (4.2) before publication, in each market it appears in. A credential seal is applied only where it has been cleared for that market.

ACCEPTANCE

Using any part of this system is acceptance of these terms. Exceptions are decided in Governance (4.3), not improvised. A recorded sign-off in that chain is the only path around any rule here.

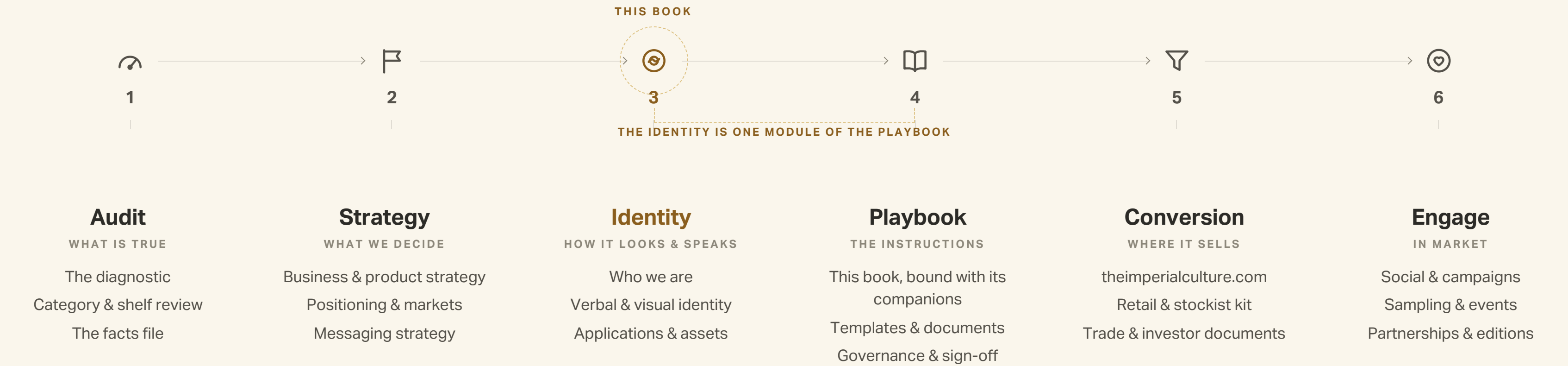
VALIDITY

This book is Brand OS v2.0. It stands until a versioned successor replaces it in Documents, and the newest master there is the only valid copy. A printed or exported copy is a snapshot, not the system.

The brand OS, mapped

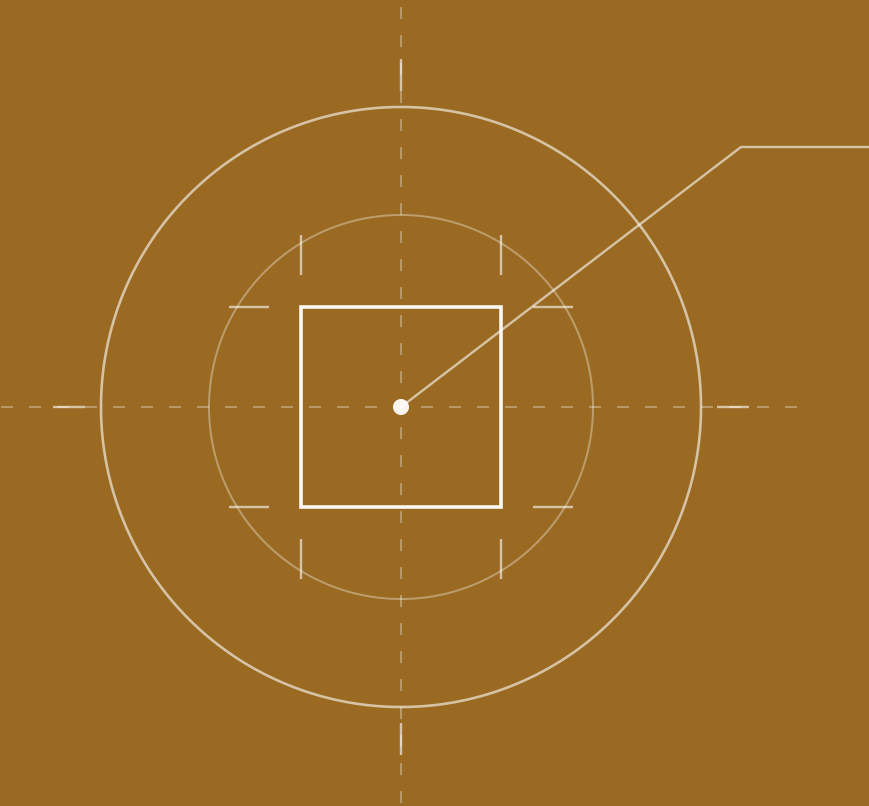
THE 6-PHASE BRANDING PROCESS
THIS BOOK IS PHASE 3 · IDENTITY

THE SIX-PHASE BRANDING PROCESS · ONE OPERATING SYSTEM



The Brand OS is all six phases combined. **This book is Phase 3 · Identity**: strategy is decided one phase earlier, the Playbook binds this book with its companion documents into the system instructions, and Conversion and Engage carry it into market. Nothing ships outside the loop.

BRAND IDENTITY



2.0

The soul of the brand, and the system that protects it.

Brand identity guidelines

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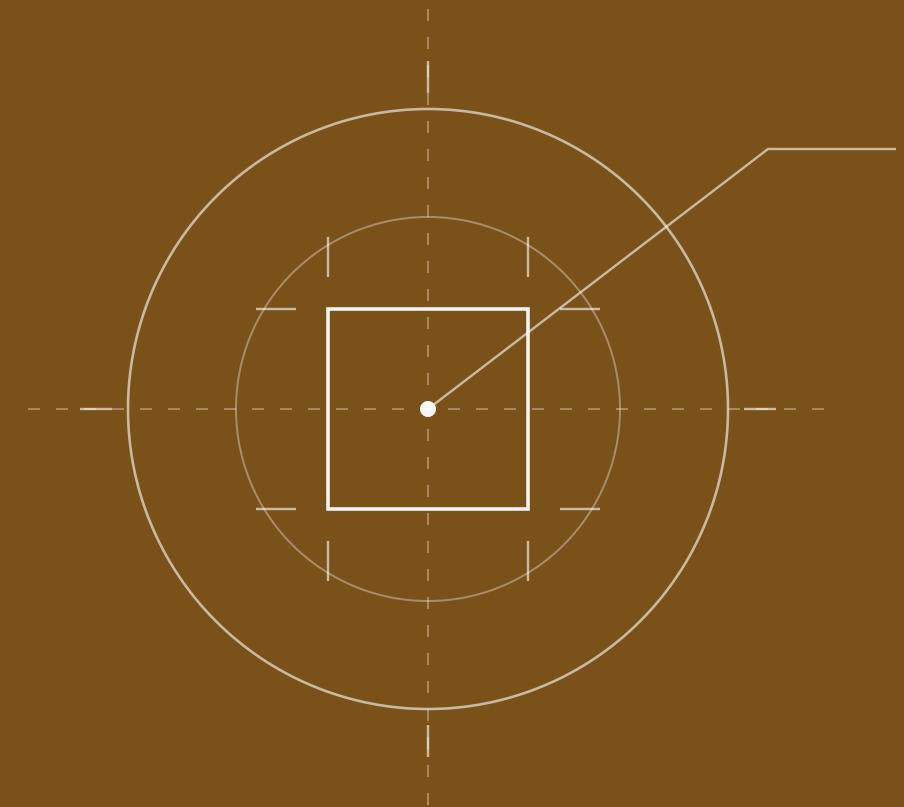
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OUR BRAND



The position the whole system defends.

2.1

Company introduction

WHAT THE IMPERIAL CULTURE IS

The Imperial Culture Sdn. Bhd. is a living culture kombucha maker: small-batch, slow-brewed, and genuinely alive.

We brew for modern, health-aware people who value quality and ritual, and we exist to make wellness feel like a pleasure, not a chore. **Real fermentation, real function, no compromise.**

THE DOUBLE MEANING · LOCKED

IN THE BOTTLE

The living culture

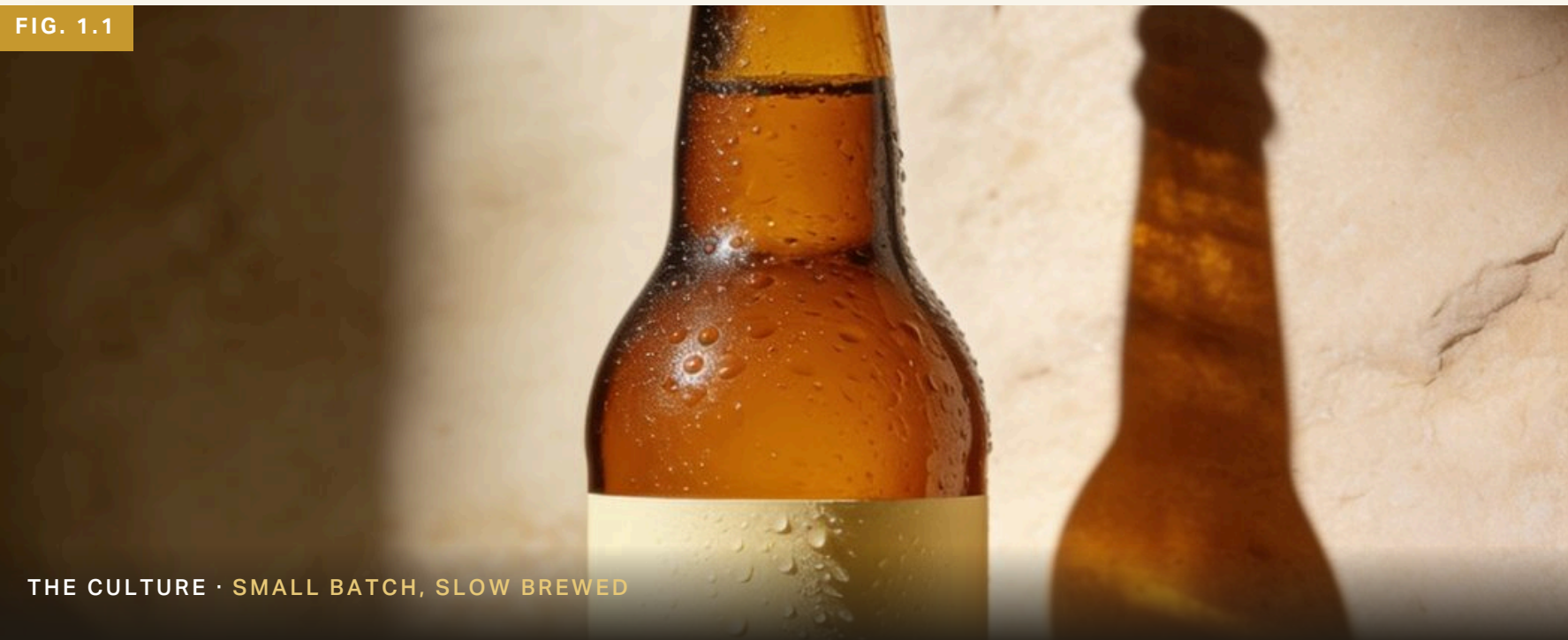
The ferment doing quiet work: live, raw and unfiltered, and the reason the drink tastes the way it does.

IN THE NAME

Culture as a way of living

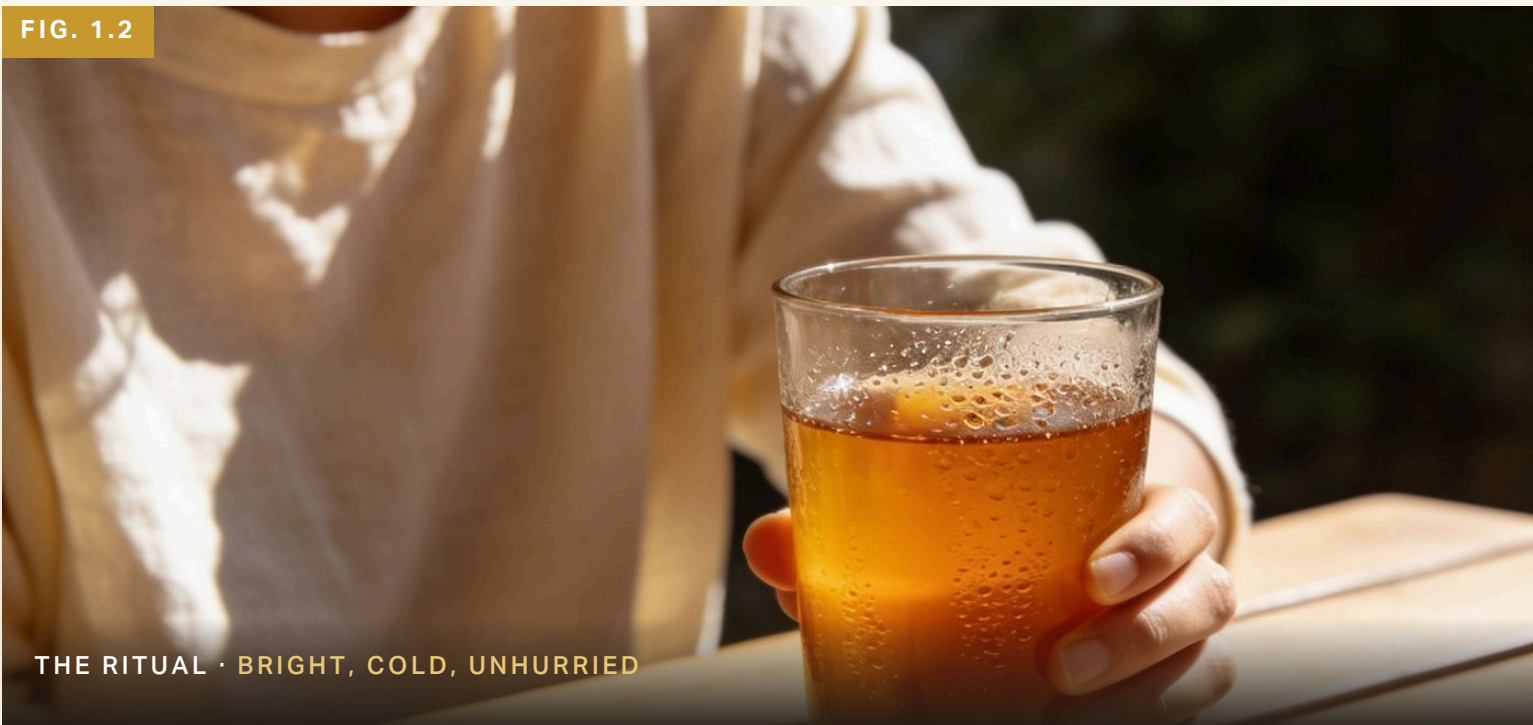
Taste, refinement and intention. The everyday ritual, made worth slowing down for.

FIG. 1.1



THE CULTURE · SMALL BATCH, SLOW BREWED

FIG. 1.2



THE RITUAL · BRIGHT, COLD, UNHURRIED

2026

FOUNDED · KUALA LUMPUR, MALAYSIA

7 days

MINIMUM FERMENT · NEVER RUSHED

0

ADDED SUGAR · LIVE, RAW, UNFILTERED

Our story

THE NAME, THE DOUBLE MEANING
CULTURE, TWICE OVER



TIME IS THE INGREDIENT

FIG. 2.1B

A brand born from patience

The Imperial Culture began with a simple idea: the best things are not rushed. Kombucha is proof, a drink that only becomes itself through time, care, and a living culture doing quiet work.

Our name carries the double meaning at the heart of the brand: **culture** as the living ferment that makes the drink alive, and **culture** as taste, refinement, and a way of living well.

Positioning & brand script

ABOVE FUNCTIONAL, BESIDE RITUAL
CRAFT IS THE COMPETITIVE EDGE

WHERE WE STAND

A premium living culture kombucha for modern people who take wellbeing seriously but refuse to make it joyless.

We sit above the functional, mass-produced end of the category, and beside the everyday rituals of people who care what they put into their bodies. We compete on craft and taste, never on price or volume.

Category	LIVING CULTURE KOMBUCHA
Tier	PREMIUM, CRAFT, SMALL BATCH
Audience	MODERN WELLNESS GENERATION
We are not	MASS, CLINICAL, HYPE-LED

POSITIONING STATEMENT

For the modern wellness generation, **The Imperial Culture** is the living culture kombucha that makes feeling good feel good, because real craft, real culture and real taste should never be a compromise.

BRAND SCRIPT

Culture takes time. We give it time, and what comes back is a drink that’s alive, bright, and good for you. This is your everyday ritual, refined.

The north star for taglines, captions and long-form copy: always warm, confident, unhurried.

Vision & mission

WHERE WE ARE GOING
AND WHAT WE DO EVERY DAY

01 VISION

Our vision

To become the most loved living culture beverage of the modern wellness generation: the brand that proved feeling good and living well were always meant to be the same thing.

02 MISSION

Our mission

To craft honest, living culture kombucha that delivers real function and real pleasure, and to build a brand experience around it that feels calm, premium and genuinely human.

Most loved

NOT THE BIGGEST · THE ONE PEOPLE CHOOSE AGAIN

Honest craft

REAL FERMENTATION · REAL FUNCTION · REAL TASTE

Values & culture

WHAT WE LIVE BY
FIVE VALUES, NO EXCEPTIONS

Five values shape every decision

From how we brew to how we speak. If a piece of work cannot be traced to at least one of these, it is not ours.

01 Honest craft
Real fermentation, real ingredients, no shortcuts.

02 Patience as quality
We let the culture take its time. Good things aren't rushed.

03 Wellbeing, not pressure
We make wellness inviting, never preachy.

04 Quiet confidence
We let quality and taste speak, calm and premium.

05 Refined living
Everyday moments deserve beauty and intention.

Brand philosophy

THE BELIEF UNDER EVERYTHING
NOT LOUDER. WARMER.



CULTURE, CULTIVATED

FIG. 2.1C

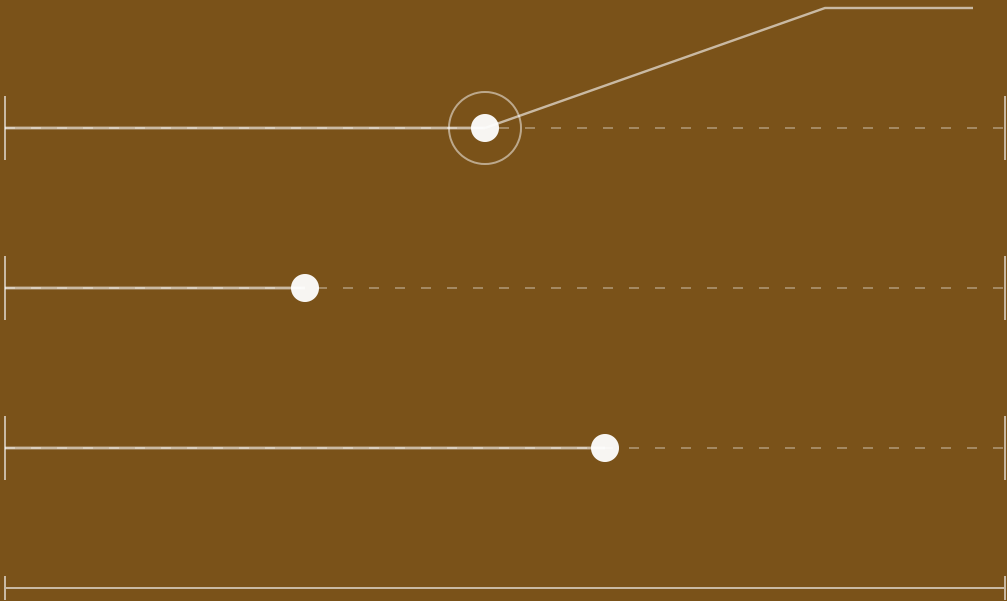
Culture, cultivated

We believe the things that are good for us should also feel good to us. Wellness has spent too long feeling like a discipline. We think it can feel like a pleasure.

So we design every part of the brand, the taste, the bottle, the words, the experience, to slow the moment down and make it feel more considered. Not louder. Warmer. More alive.

The Imperial Culture is about creating something people are glad to make part of their day, again and again.

VERBAL IDENTITY



How the brand sounds: warm, honest, quietly confident.

2.2

Voice & character

HOW WE SPEAK
WE INVITE, WE NEVER OVERSELL

The Imperial Culture speaks like a well-travelled friend who knows their craft: warm, assured, and easy to be around. We never oversell. We invite.

BRAND VOICE

Warm & assured

Confident without being loud, refined without being cold. Plain, generous and human.

BRAND CHARACTER

The considered host

The maker who cares about the details and wants you to enjoy the result, never lecturing.

PERSONALITY

Calm & cultured

Health literate but never preachy; makes wellness look like the most natural pleasure.

WE ARE

- WARM
- HONEST
- CRAFTED
- CONFIDENT
- UPLIFTING
- REFINED

WE ARE NOT

- LOUD
- PREACHY
- CLINICAL
- TREND CHASING
- GIMMICKY
- COLD

Tone principles

VOICE IS FIXED · TONE FLEXES
FIVE PRINCIPLES, EVERY MESSAGE

Five ways we communicate

Voice stays constant; tone flexes to the moment. These five principles keep every message sounding like The Imperial Culture.

- 01

Warm & confident
Lead with warmth and quiet certainty, never arrogant, never anxious.
- 02

Honest & unhurried
Tell the truth about the craft, and take time to say it well.
- 03

Inviting, not preachy
Open the door to good living; never wag a finger.
- 04

Crafted & considered
Every word chosen with the same care as the brew.
- 05

Alive & uplifting
Bright and effervescent; leave people feeling brighter.

How we communicate

✓ DO

- ✓ Speak plainly and generously, as if sharing something good.
- ✓ Be transparent about craft, ingredients and process.
- ✓ Frame wellness as pleasure and ritual, not duty.
- ✓ Edit ruthlessly: say more with less.
- ✓ Bring warmth, lightness and a little effervescence.

✗ DON'T

- ✗ Oversell, exaggerate, or stack superlatives.
- ✗ Make vague or unprovable health promises.
- ✗ Shame, guilt or moralise about health.
- ✗ Use filler, clichés or lazy buzzwords.
- ✗ Sound flat, cold, corporate or clinical.

Worked example. “Brewed slow and honest, bright on the tongue, kind to the gut.”

Off-brand example. “The #1 detox superdrink that finally fixes your gut, guaranteed!”

Verbal messaging

FOUR TERRITORIES
EVERY MESSAGE LADDERS TO ONE

01 The craft & culture
Real fermentation, patience, living cultures, honest ingredients.

02 Feeling good, made easy
Functional wellbeing as pleasure, never clinical or preachy.

03 The everyday ritual
The midday reset, the good table, the small pause.

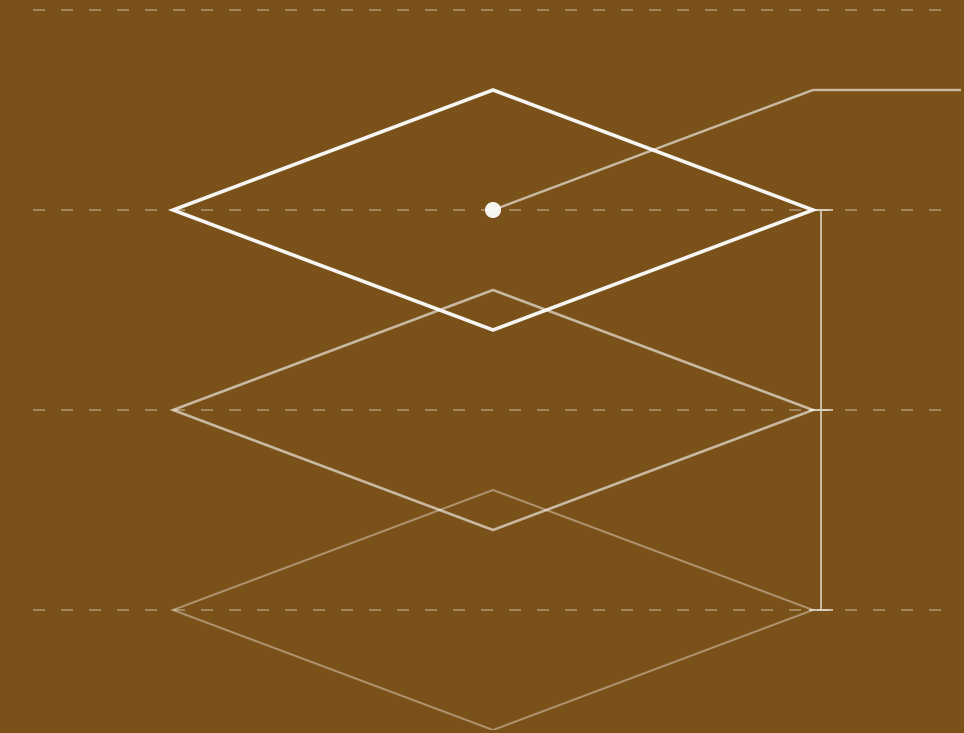
04 Refined modern living
Taste, design, intention: wellness can be beautiful.

TAGLINE
Live cultured.

PRODUCT
“Brewed slow and honest, bright on the tongue, kind to the gut.”

SOCIAL
“Good things take culture. Yours is chilling in the fridge.”

VISUAL IDENTITY



How the brand looks, and the rules that keep it recognisable.

2.3

Art direction

MOOD · LIGHT · TEXTURE · SPACE
PREMIUM AND CALM

The brand looks the way it tastes

Warm, alive and refined. Amber light, effervescence, natural texture
and generous space combine into a world that feels premium and calm.



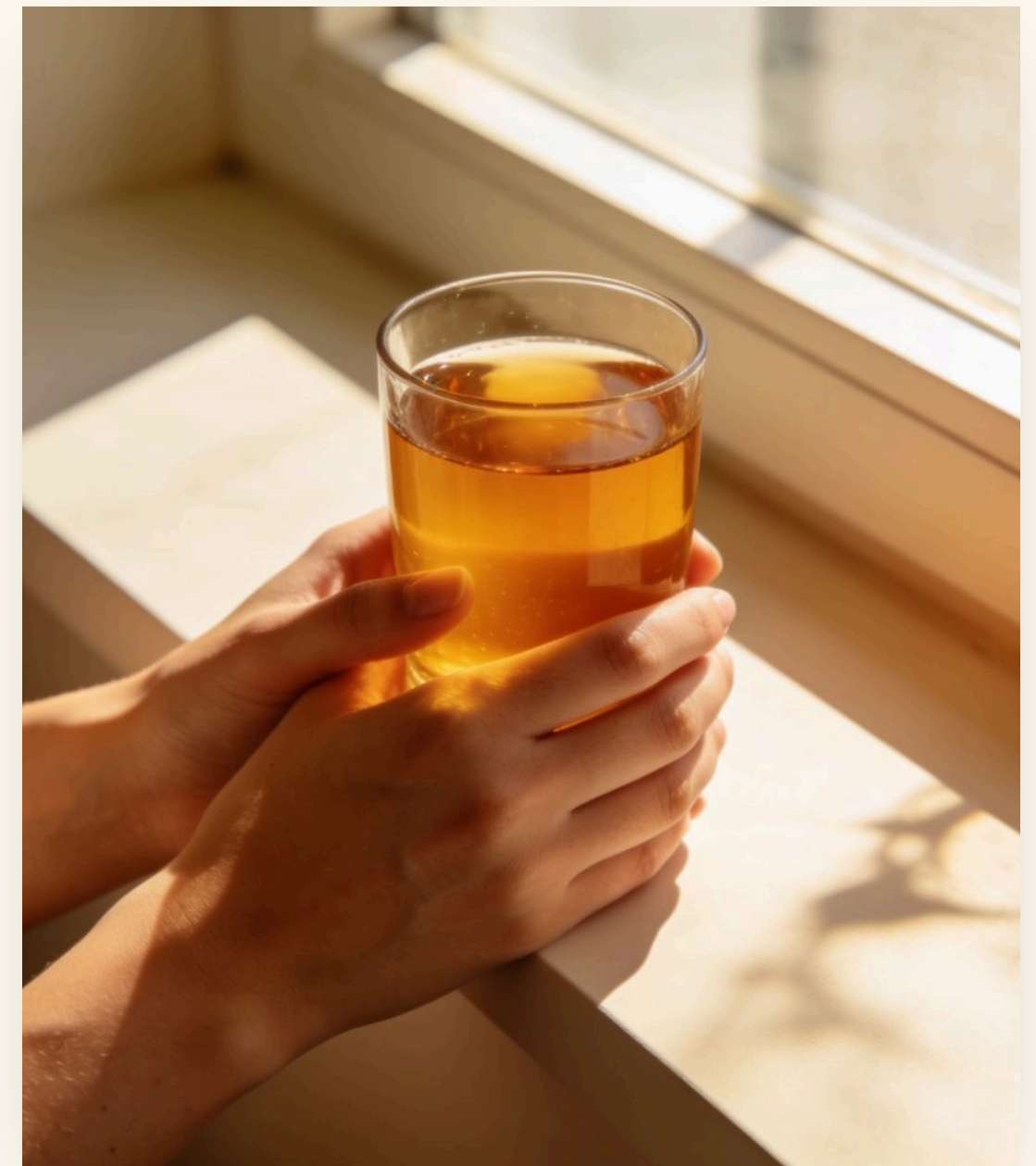
MOOD · WARM, EFFERVESCENT, ALIVE

01



LIGHT · GOLDEN HOUR, HONEST SHADOW

02



TEXTURE · GLASS, TEA, CERAMIC, STONE

03

Design principles

Four principles govern every design decision in this book. Where a layout is in doubt, the principle wins over the preference.

01

Warmth through light
Amber tones and soft light make every surface feel inviting and human, like golden hour, never cold.

02

Alive & effervescent
Bubbles, movement and living texture give the brand energy: bright, active, full of life.

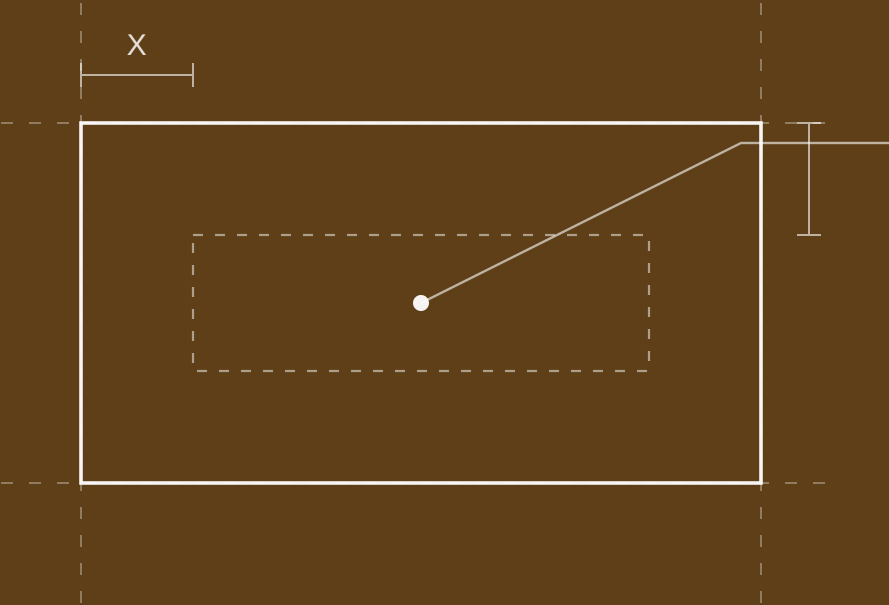
03

Refined restraint
Premium is subtraction. Generous space, clean structure, one confident focal point. Nothing crowded.

04

Honest & natural
Real texture over gloss, real moments over staging. The craft is the story.

THE LOGO



One mark, built on the X unit.

2.3.1

The logo system

FOUR APPROVED FORMS
NEVER REBUILD THE LOCKUP

Status. Both marks are supplied artwork and are placed, never rebuilt: the wordmark lockup, and the owl as the standalone brand mark. These frames define construction, spacing, sizing, colourways and misuse for both.



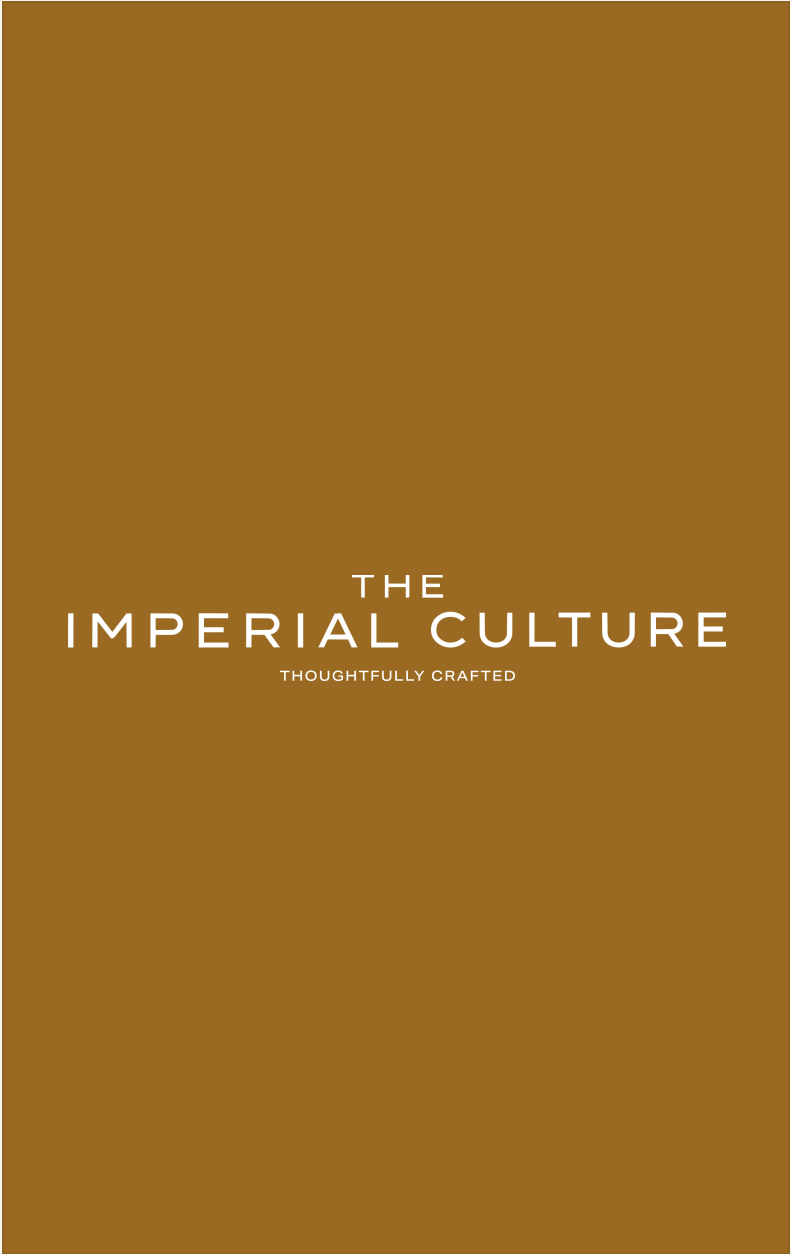
PRIMARY · INK ON CREAM

A



REVERSED · ON INK

B



REVERSED · ON AMBER

C



BRAND MARK · ICON

D

Construction & clear space

THE X UNIT GOVERNS EVERYTHING
CLEARSPACE = X



BUILT ON A GRID

X is the cap height of IMPERIAL CULTURE in the supplied lockup. Every measurement in the mark is a multiple of it, and minimum clearspace on all sides equals X: that zone stays free of type, imagery and competing elements.

In print, clearspace is never less than 5 mm on the sides or 10 mm top and bottom, whichever is larger.

The unit X	CAP HEIGHT OF IMPERIAL CULTURE
Lockup height	2.97 X
Lockup width	18.49 X · RATIO 6.21 : 1
“THE” cap	0.66 X · SITS 0.39 X ABOVE
Tagline cap	0.29 X · SITS 0.64 X BELOW
Clearspace	X ON EVERY SIDE, ALL FORMS

No other element, type or image may enter the exclusion zone.
When a layout cannot hold it, the layout changes, not the clearspace.

Logo sizes, the floors

FOUR FLOORS · NEVER BELOW
LEGIBILITY OUTRANKS LAYOUT

THE
IMPERIAL CULTURE
THOUGHTFULLY CRAFTED

LARGE · COVERS, OOH · 300PX

THE
IMPERIAL CULTURE
THOUGHTFULLY CRAFTED

MEDIUM · PRINT, PACK · 200PX

THE
IMPERIAL CULTURE
THOUGHTFULLY CRAFTED

MINIMUM · DIGITAL FLOOR · 140PX



BRAND MARK · BELOW THE WORDMARK FLOOR · 40PX

MINIMUM SIZE

Below these floors the tagline is dropped first, then the wordmark gives way to the brand mark. A mark that cannot be read is not a mark.

Primary · digital140 PX WIDE MINIMUM

Primary · print28 MM WIDE MINIMUM

Brand mark · digital40 PX MINIMUM

Brand mark · print12 MM MINIMUM

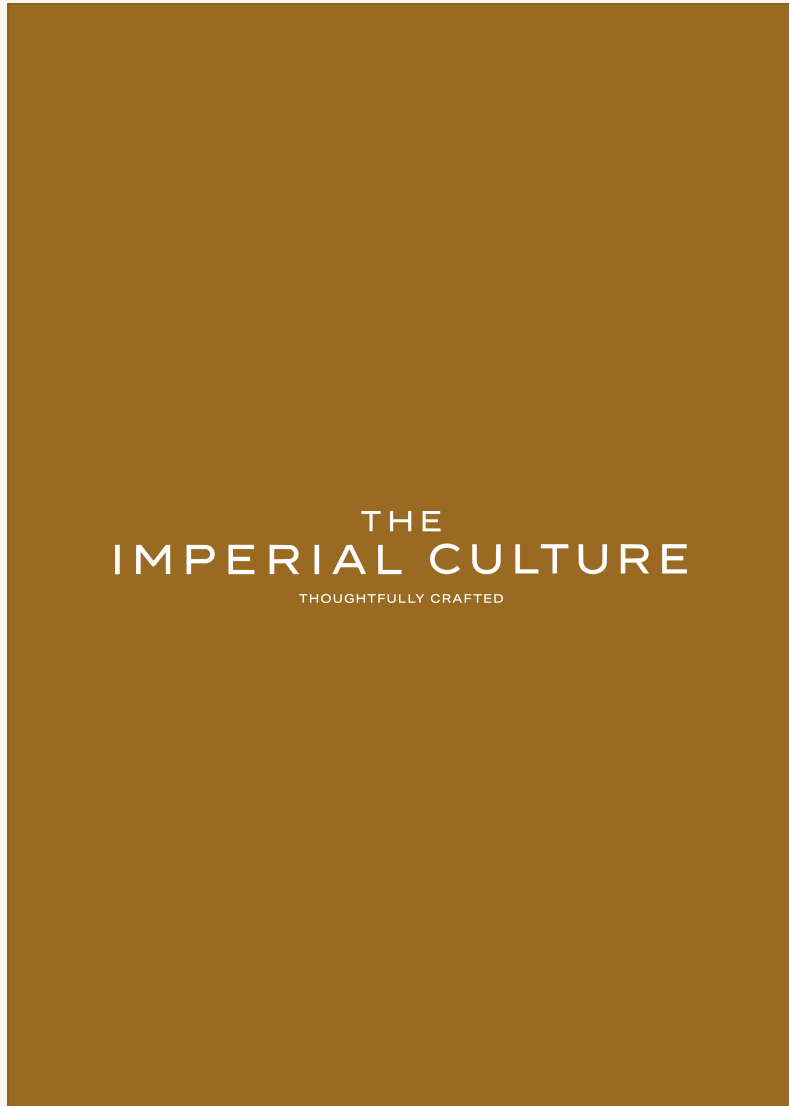
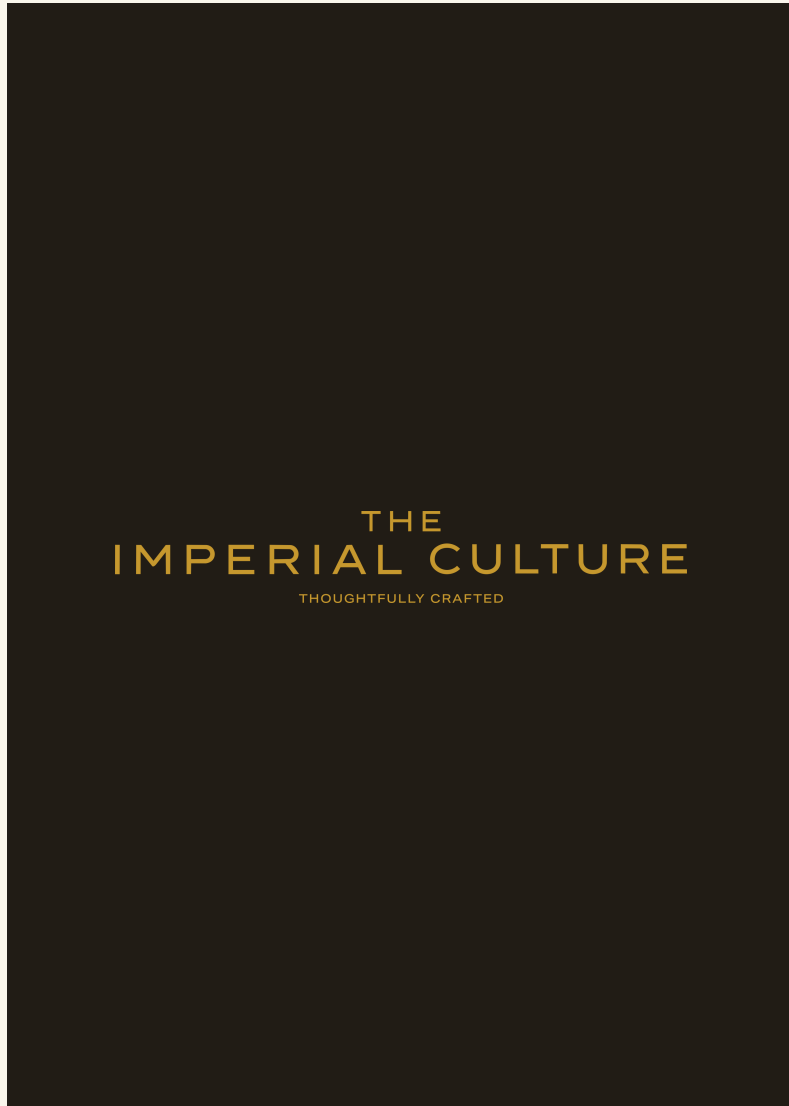
The mark’s own floor. The owl is drawn artwork, not a monogram: below 40 px its feathering and the branch stop resolving. Where a smaller mark is genuinely needed, the wordmark or the brand block is used instead, never a redrawn simplification of the owl.

Tagline. “Thoughtfully Crafted” is part of the supplied lockup, not type we set. Below the digital floor it stops being legible, so the mark gives way to the brand mark rather than the tagline being reset or removed.

Colourways & backgrounds

FOUR COLOURWAYS · NO OTHERS
CONTRAST IS NOT NEGOTIABLE

Four approved colourways. Gold-on-ink and ink-on-cream are primary; everything else is a controlled exception.

							
INK, ON CREAM	PRIMARY	REVERSED WHITE, ON AMBER	PRIMARY	IMPERIAL GOLD, ON INK	APPROVED	MONO INK, SINGLE COLOUR	APPROVED

Rule. Only place the logo on backgrounds that keep full contrast. On busy photography, use the reversed mark inside a solid brand block, never floating on the image.

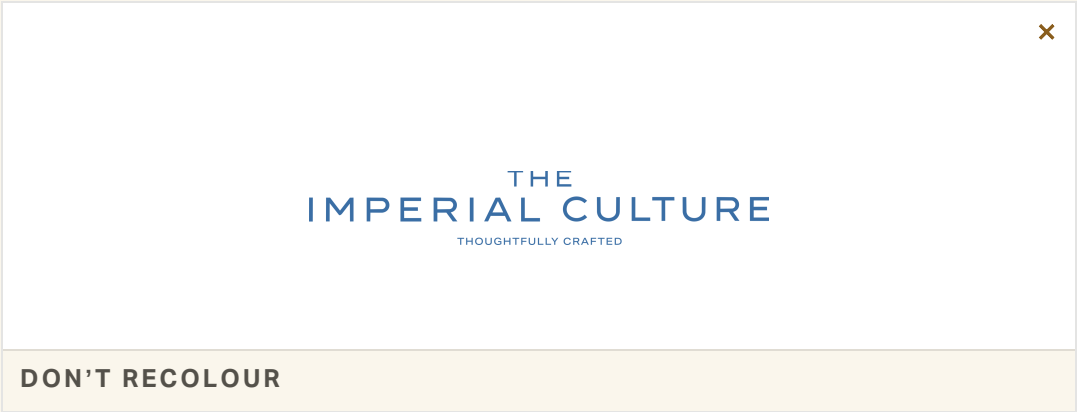
Logo misuse

SIX WAYS TO BREAK IT
ALL SIX ARE FORBIDDEN

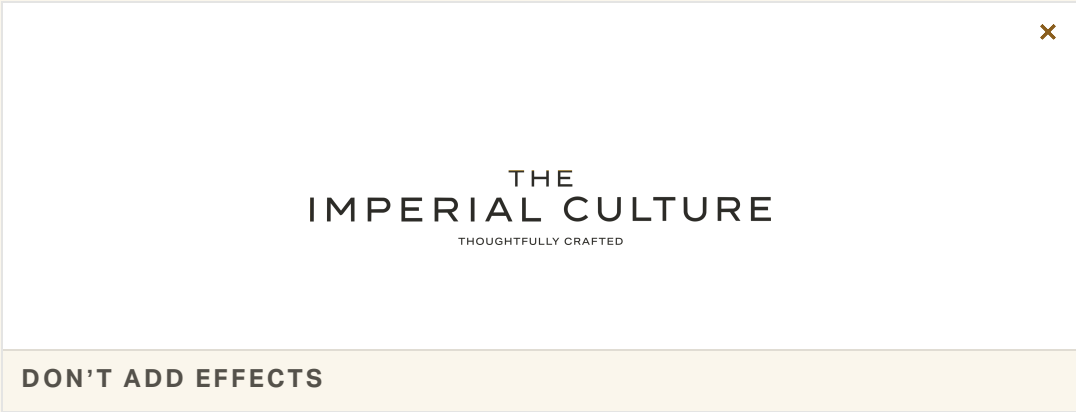
The logo’s integrity is the brand’s integrity. These rules are absolute, with no exceptions for any channel, partner or campaign.



Never stretch, squash or skew.



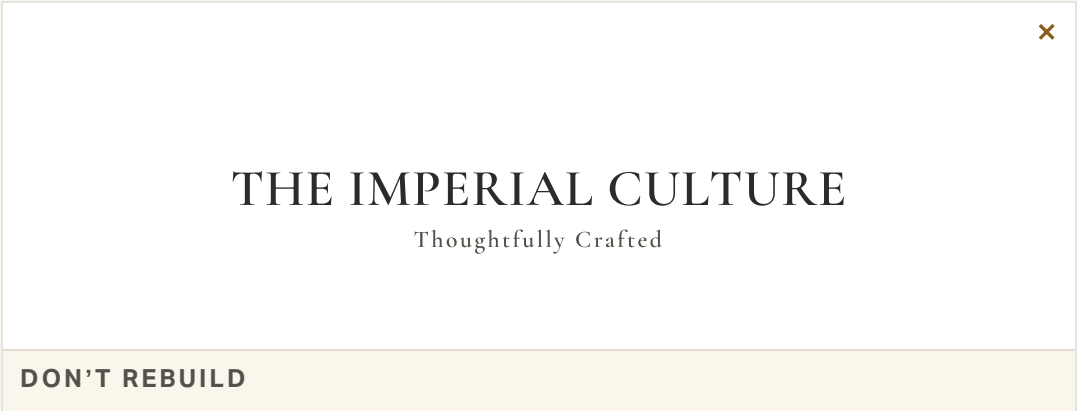
Only the four approved colourways.



No shadows, glows or outlines.



Never place on low-contrast grounds.

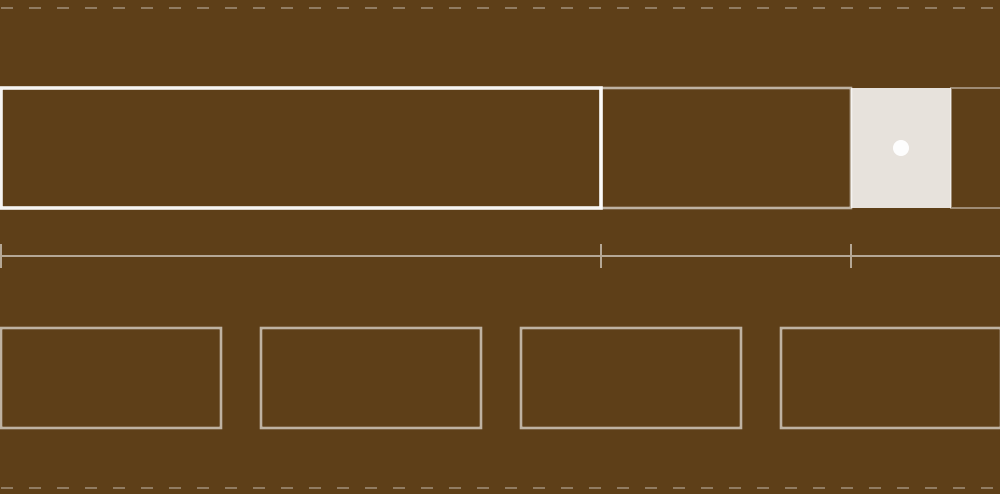


Never re-type or re-space the lockup.



The lockup is always level.

COLOUR



A palette drawn from the brew.

2.3.2

A palette drawn from the brew

THE RATIO IS THE IDENTITY
GOLD IS THE SIGNAL, NEVER THE FIELD

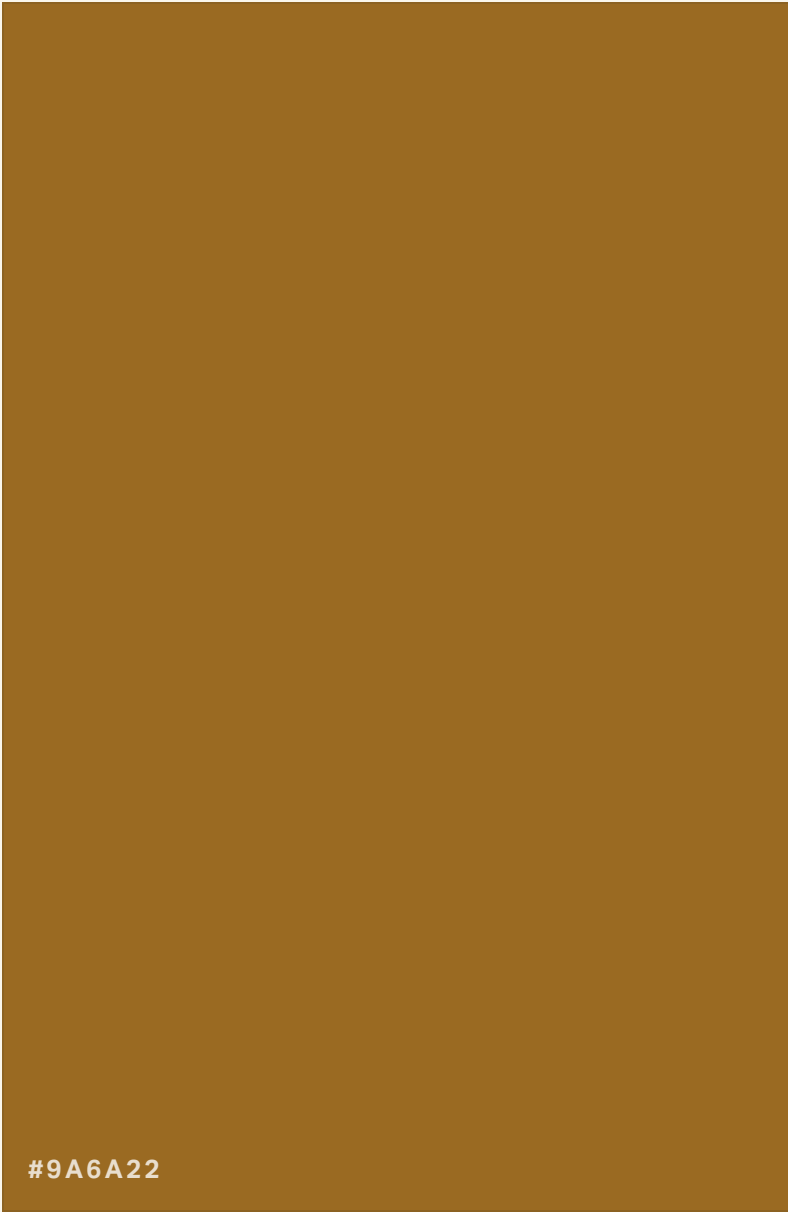


#C6982E

Imperial Gold

CMYK 0/23/76/22
RGB 198/152/46

The single accent. Marks, rules, highlights.

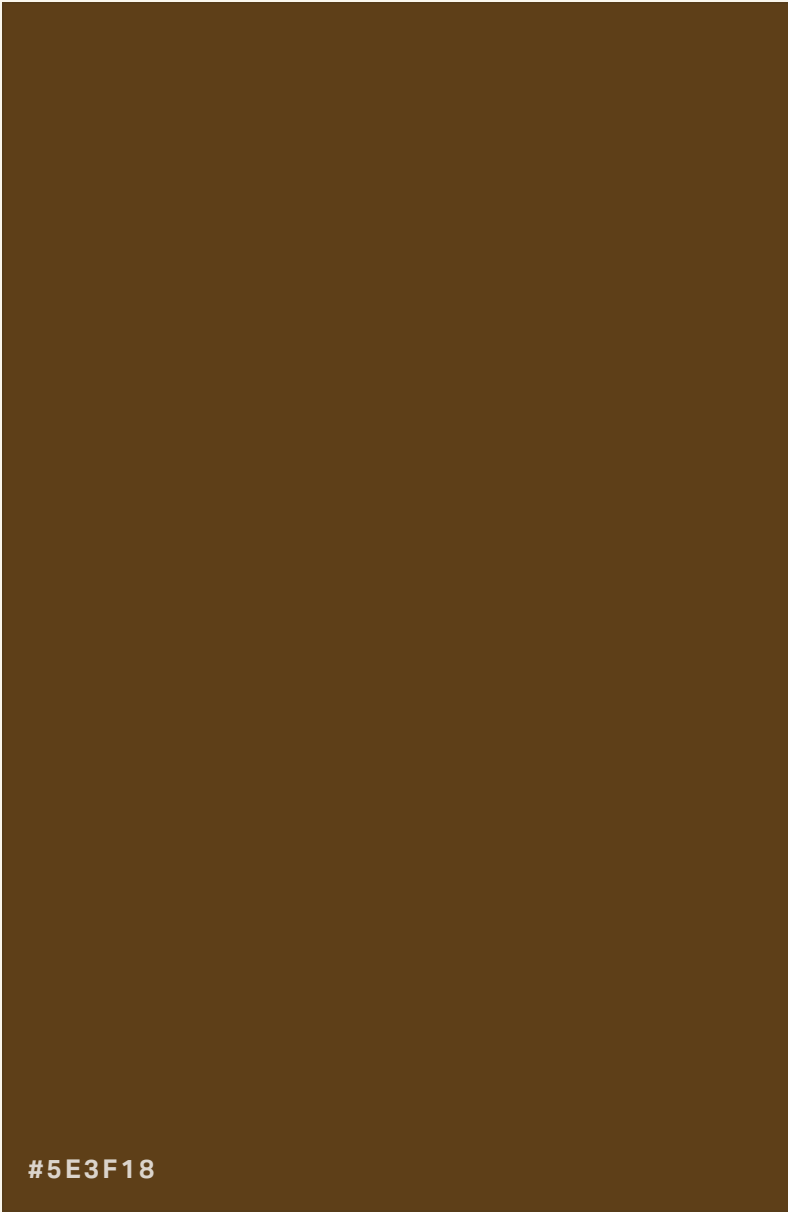


#9A6A22

Amber Brew

CMYK 0/32/78/40
RGB 154/106/34

Section fields, depth, secondary accent.

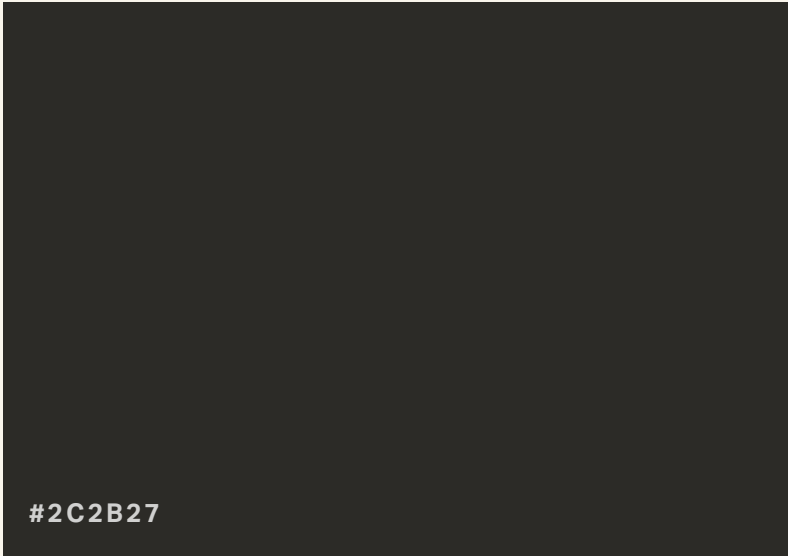


#5E3F18

Deep Brew

CMYK 0/33/74/63
RGB 94/63/24

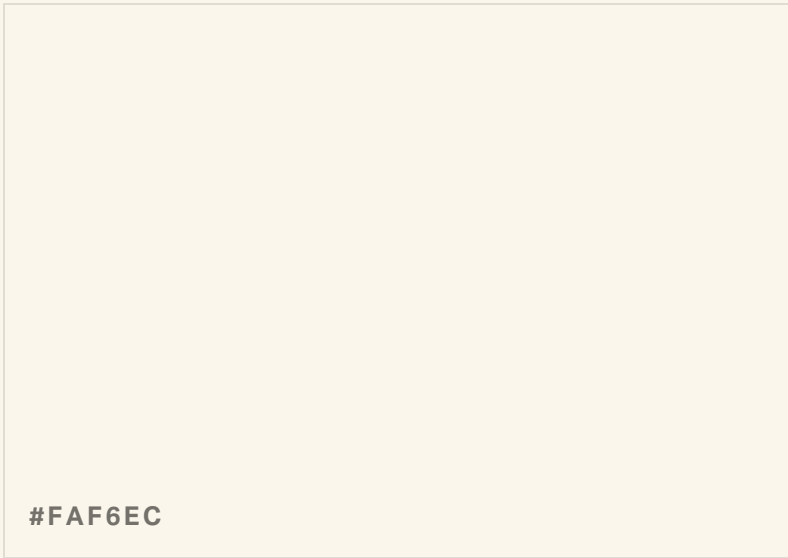
Deep contrast, premium packaging, gradient base.



#2C2B27

Imperial Ink

CMYK 0/3/12/83 · RGB 44/43/39
Primary text & dark surfaces.



#FAF6EC

Cream Paper

CMYK 2/2/8/0 · RGB 250/246/236
The primary background canvas.

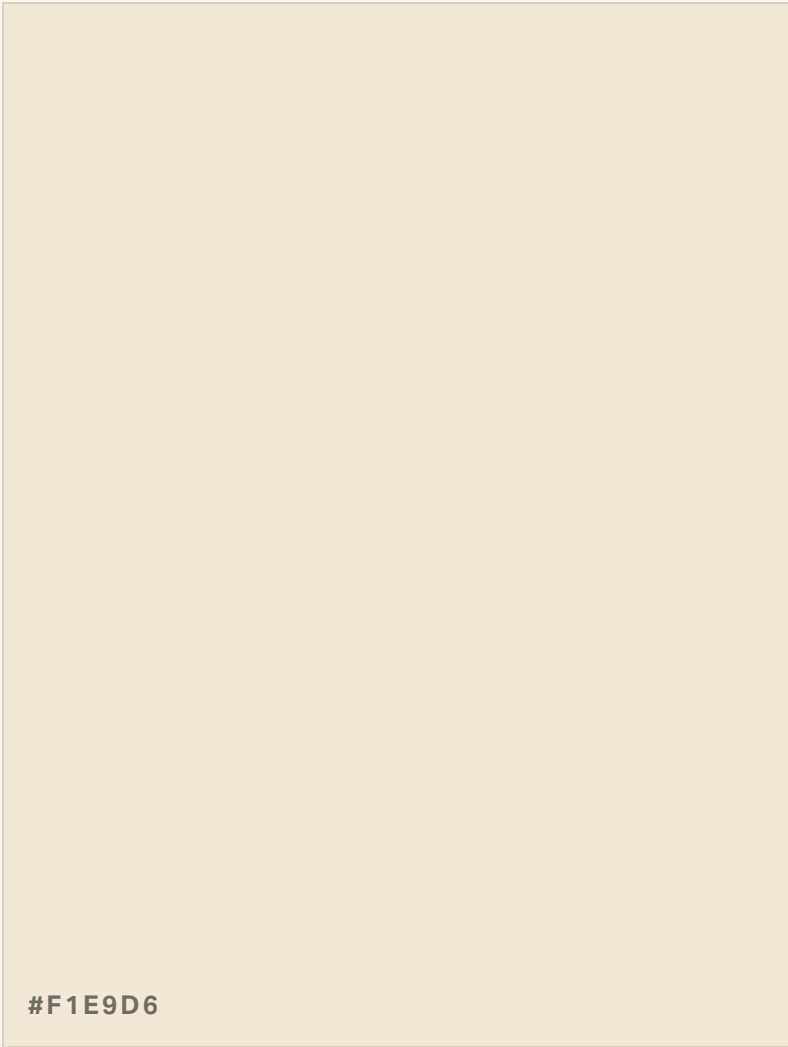
Support & balance

SECONDARIES · RATIO · GRADIENT
60 / 25 / 10 / 5



Ginger Fizz

Highlights, effervescence, bright touches.



Warm Sand

Secondary blocks, cards, alternating sections.



Soft Ink

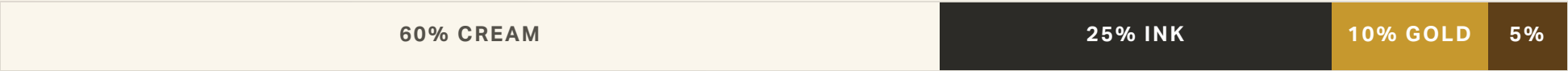
Body copy, captions, secondary text.



Deep Brew

Deep contrast and the gradient base.

USAGE RATIO · THE IDENTITY



Cream carries the page, ink carries the words, gold marks the moment, the amber family adds depth. Change the ratio and the brand stops looking like itself, even with the right hexes.

LIVING GRADIENT



#E7C877 → #C6982E → #9A6A22 → #5E3F18. Hero surfaces and packaging only, never behind body copy.

Suggested pairing ✓

These pairings are set so the mark and the type stay legible on every surface, on screen, in print and on pack. Each clears the AA contrast floor and keeps Imperial Gold working as a signal rather than a field.

Use them as supplied. A pairing that is not on this page routes through the brand custodian before it ships.

CREAM · INK

Live cultured.

THE DEFAULT PAGE

INK · GINGER

Live cultured.

DARK SHOWPIECE

AMBER · WHITE

Live cultured.

SECTION FIELDS

SAND · DEEP BREW

Live cultured.

CARDS & ALTERNATES

Avoid pairing !

These combinations compromise readability, contrast and balance. Gold on cream, ginger on cream and gold on amber all fall below the contrast floor.

Gold never carries a paragraph and never becomes a section background: it marks, it does not fill. A mark set on a gradient or a busy photograph loses its edge.

If a surface cannot hold an approved pairing, the surface is redesigned, not the palette. Nothing here is re-tinted to make a layout work.

GOLD ON CREAM

Live cultured.

FAILS CONTRAST · 2.45:1

GINGER ON CREAM

Live cultured.

FAILS CONTRAST · 1.51:1

GOLD ON AMBER

Live cultured.

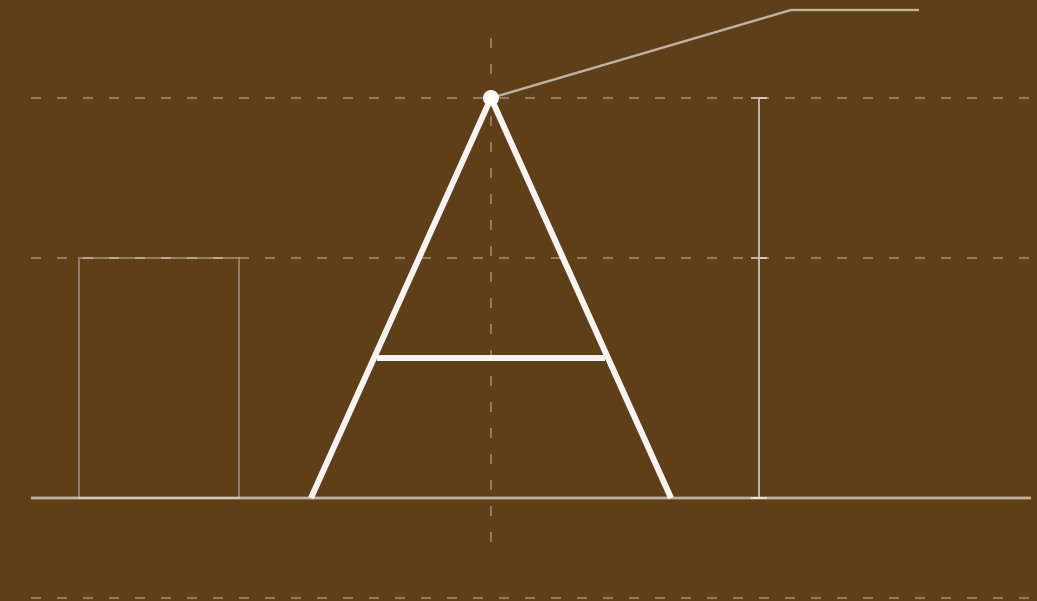
NO SEPARATION

INK ON DEEP BREW

Live cultured.

MUDDY · UNREADABLE

TYPOGRAPHY



Two faces, three jobs, one ladder.

BRAND OS V2.0

PAGES 35 → 38

2.3.3

The type system

TWO TYPEFACES, THREE JOBS
NO THIRD FACE, EVER

Aa Gg 26

Aktiv Grotesk

PRIMARY · DISPLAY, BODY, LABELS, NUMERALS

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ 0123456789

- 200 Thin · oversized display only
- 300 Light · large statements
- 400 Regular · body copy, captions
- 500 Medium · page titles, wordmark
- 700 Bold · headings, labels, emphasis

Aa Gg 26

Cormorant Garamond

SECONDARY · SECTION TITLES & EDITORIAL ACCENTS

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

- Roman Section titles, pull quotes, flavour names
- Italic Editorial asides, flavour names, tasting notes

Culture, cultivated

Golden Ginger · Wild Hibiscus

Fresh ginger, citrus zest, green tea

Two faces, no third. Aktiv Grotesk carries all display, body and interface text. Cormorant lends an elegant serif voice to section titles and editorial moments, never to body copy.

Aktiv Grotesk

FIVE WEIGHTS IN USE
THE WHOLE BRAND, ONE FAMILY

Aa

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
0123456789 & % . , ; : ! ? “ ”

Thin · 200

Light · 300

Regular · 400

Medium · 500

Bold · 700

Aktiv Grotesk is licensed. Where a system font is required, in email, documents or in-store screens, substitute Century Gothic or Futura for display and Arial or Helvetica for body. Never mix a substitute with the licensed face in the same layout.

Hierarchy in use

SIX STEPS · NOTHING BETWEEN
THE LADDER IS THE LAYOUT

DISPLAY

Live cultured.

AKTIV GROTESK · 500 · 104PX

H1 · PAGE TITLE

A living culture, brewed with intention

AKTIV GROTESK · 500 · 72PX · -3% TRACK

H2 · SECTION

Modern wellness, refined

AKTIV GROTESK · 700 · 46PX

EDITORIAL

Culture, cultivated

CORMORANT GARAMOND · ITALIC · 40PX

BODY

Small-batch living culture kombucha, bright on the tongue and kind to the gut.

AKTIV GROTESK · 400 · 21PX · LH 1.62

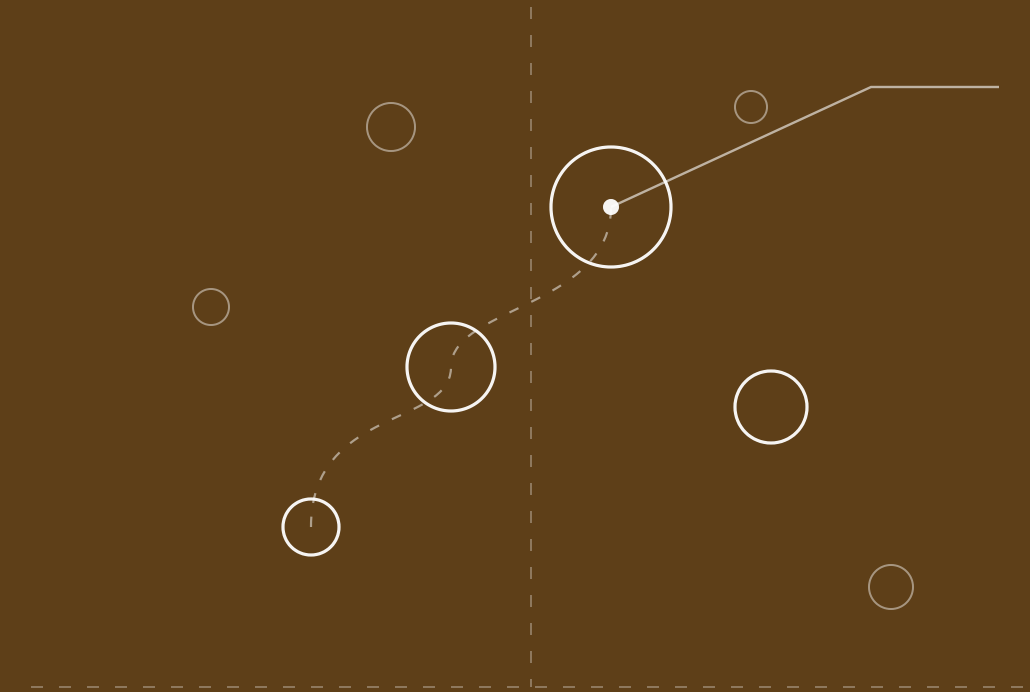
LABEL

THE IMPERIAL CULTURE · EST. 2026

AKTIV GROTESK · 700 · 14PX · +20% TRACK

The ladder is fixed. Every page in this book is set from these six steps. A new size is not invented for a layout: the layout is rebuilt on the ladder.

DESIGN ELEMENTS



A small kit that extends the brand across surfaces.

2.3.4

Elements & pattern

THREE ELEMENTS · NO MORE
NONE COMPETES WITH THE MARK

Three supporting graphics, and no more: the effervescence motif, the living gradient and the brand block. Each has one job, and none of them competes with the mark.



EFFERVESCENCE · RISING BUBBLES **E1**

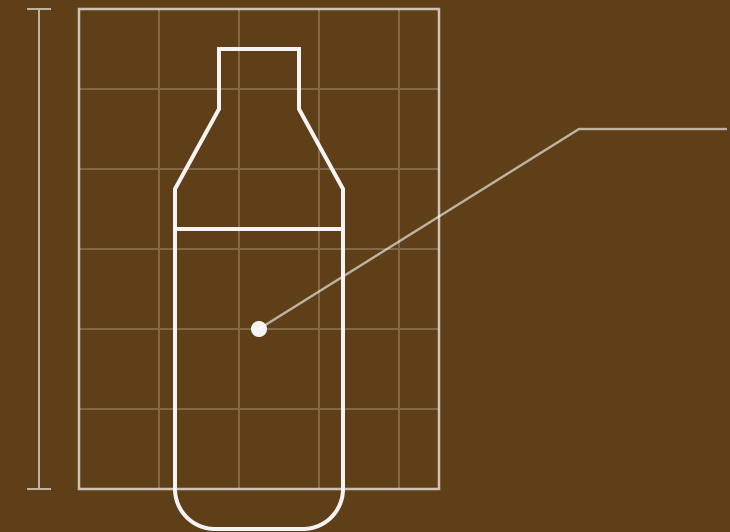


LIVING GRADIENT · HERO & PACK **E2**



BRAND BLOCK · LOGO CONTAINER **E3**

ICONOGRAPHY



One weight, one grid, one colour.

The icon system

1.6PX STROKE · 24PX GRID
ONE WEIGHT, ONE COLOUR

Icons are simple, geometric and single weight, drawn from the same construction as the logo. They inform quickly and add warmth without clutter.



BOTTLE · CRAFT



CULTURE · LIVE



BOTANICAL · TEA



GINGER · FUNCTION



FERMENT · TIME



GLASS · SERVE



EFFERVESCENCE



GUT FRIENDLY



NO ADDED SUGAR



SMALL BATCH



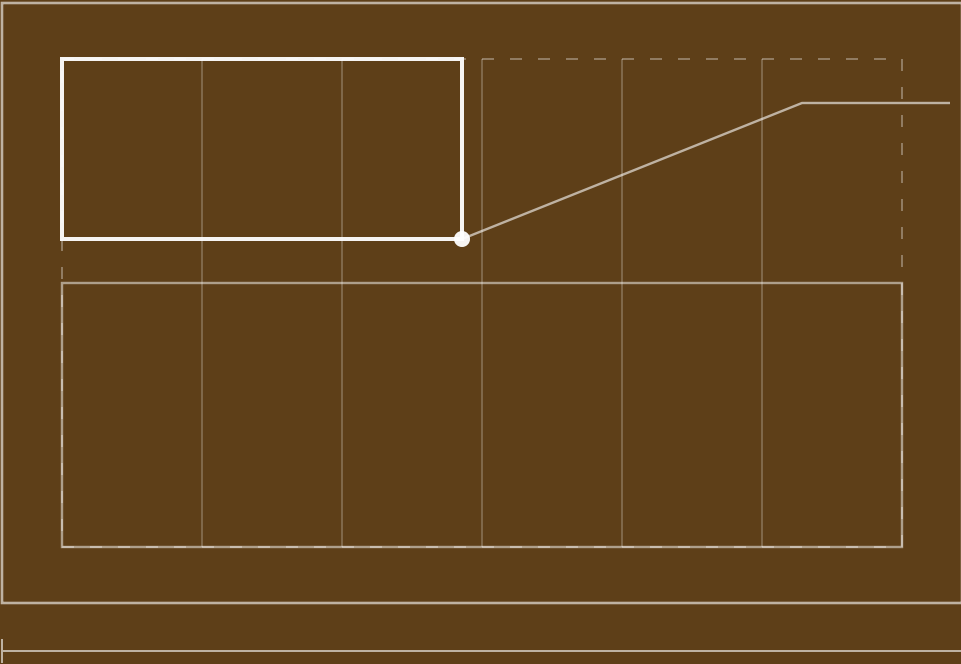
100% VEGAN



APPROVED

Style. 1.6 px stroke on a 24 px grid, rounded joins, geometric forms, single colour (Deep Brew or Imperial Ink). Never fill icons with gradients, never mix weights, never add a second colour. The set above is illustrative of the final library.

COMPOSITION



Generous, editorial, unhurried.

2.3.6

Composition & layout

FOUR RULES · ONE GRID
SPACE IS THE PREMIUM SIGNAL

GENEROUS & EDITORIAL

- 01

Lead with space
Wide margins and clear breathing room. Never fill every corner.
- 02

One focal point
Each composition has a single hero. Everything else supports it.
- 03

Consistent grid
Align to the 12 column grid.
Structure creates calm rhythm.
- 04

Type does the work
Confident type and honest imagery carry the layout.

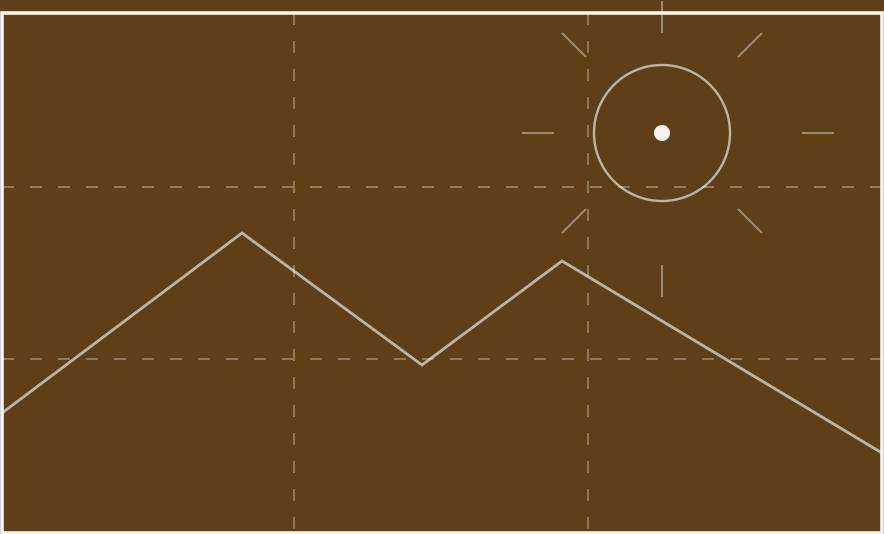
Page	1920 × 1080 · 12 COL
Margins	112 PX SIDES · 48 / 32 TOP & FOOT
Gutter	40 PX · COLUMN 104.7 PX
Spacing	4 / 8 / 12 / 16 / 24 / 32 / 40 / 48 / 64 / 96



POSTER WIREFRAME · A2 PORTRAIT

FIG. 2.3F

IMAGERY



Warm, natural light and honest texture.

2.3.7

Photography & art direction

WARM · NATURAL · HONEST
REAL TEXTURE OVER GLOSS



GOLDEN HOUR · SOFT DIRECTIONAL ✓



REAL TEXTURE · GLASS, TEA, STONE ✓



CALM · ONE CLEAR FOCAL POINT ✓

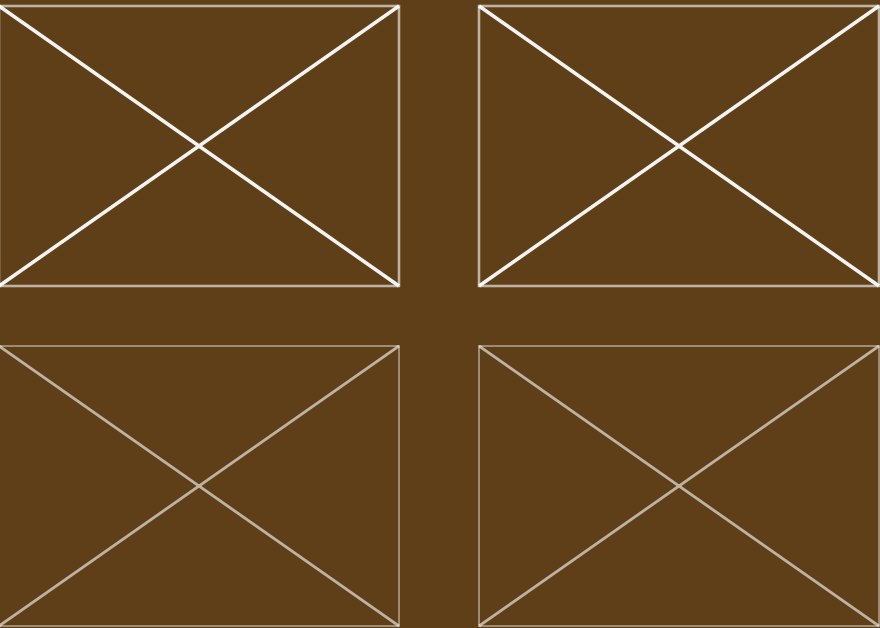
✓ DO

- ✓ Shoot in warm, natural, golden-hour light.
- ✓ Show real texture: glass, condensation, tea, stone.
- ✓ Keep compositions calm with one clear focal point.

✗ DON'T

- ✗ Use cold, blue or harsh flat lighting.
- ✗ Over-style, over-retouch or fake perfection.
- ✗ Use clichéd stock or clinical health imagery.

SYSTEM DON'TS



The whole surface, not just the mark.

2.3.8

System don'ts

SIX WAYS TO DILUTE IT
NONE OF THEM SHIP

Misuse is not only a logo problem. These are the six ways the wider system gets diluted, in order of how often it happens.

COLOUR

Gold as a page field, new tints, or off-palette accents.

TYPE

A third typeface, synthetic bold or italic, or a size off the ladder.

LAYOUT

Crowded corners, competing focal points, or content outside the margins.

IMAGERY

Cold light, clinical staging, or the mark floating on a busy photograph.

ELEMENTS

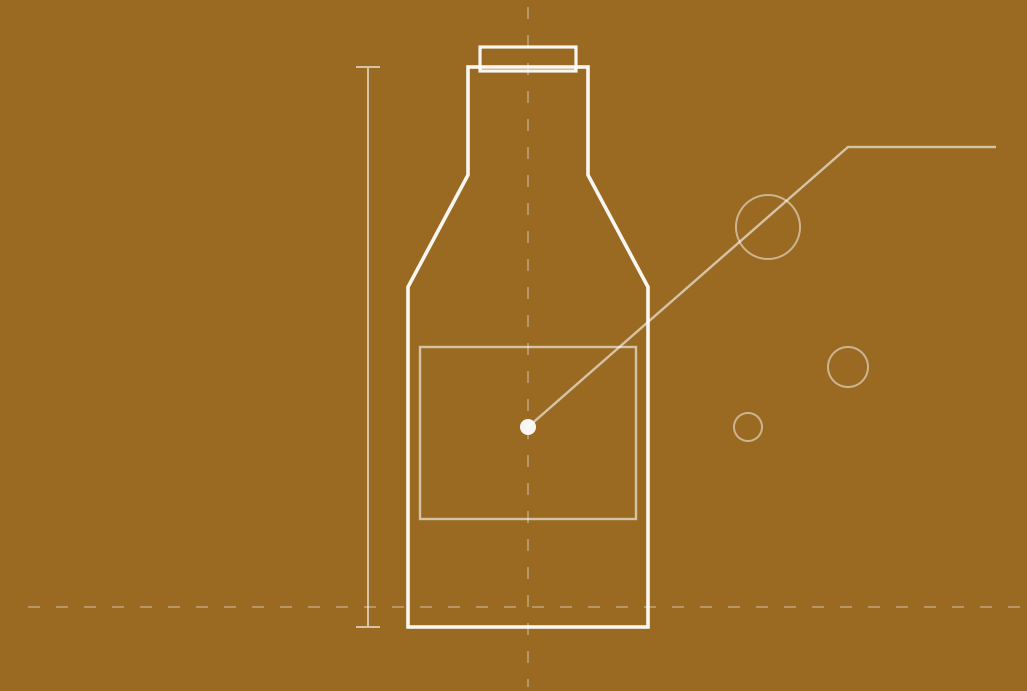
Bubbles behind body copy, gradients under text, or a fourth element.

ONE

Discount-led shouting, health claims, or hype in any channel.

The check. If a piece of work would still be recognisable as ours with the logo removed, the system is working. If it needs the logo to be identifiable, something on this page has gone wrong.

APPLICATIONS



Where the brand meets the world, one surface at a time.

3.0

Applications & touchpoints

FROM BOTTLE TO BILLBOARD
ONE SYSTEM, EVERY SURFACE

3.1 Packaging & product

The bottle, the label, the box tiers and the range architecture

- The bottle & label
- The product
- Tasting notes
- Credentials & seals
- The box tier system
- Product architecture

3.2 Corporate & print

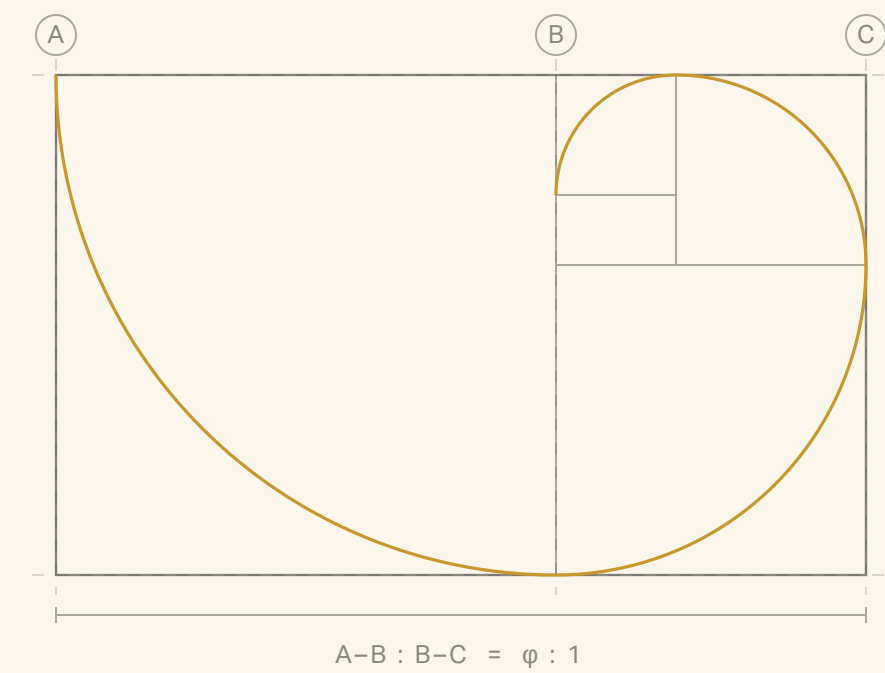
The business face of the brand, in the hand and on the desk

- Stationery
- Everyday collateral

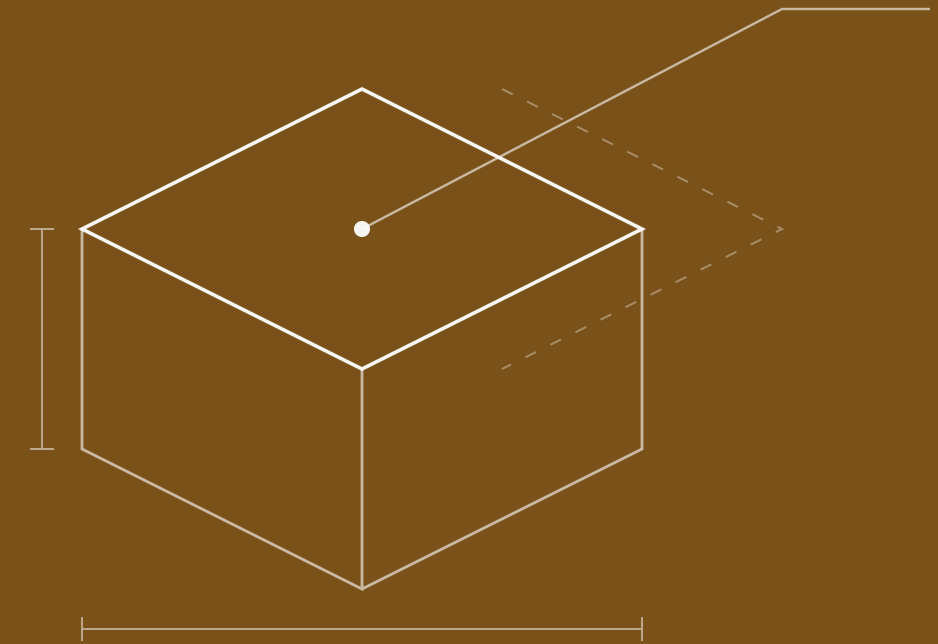
3.3 Marketing & digital

How the brand shows up and speaks at scale

- Social media
- Website & commerce
- Out of home
- Video & motion



PACKAGING



Our loudest, quietest statement.

3.1

The bottle & label

THE BRAND'S ICON
ONE MARK, ONE FLAVOUR NAME



The bottle & label

Packaging is our loudest, quietest statement. The bottle is the brand’s icon: clean glass, the amber brew showing through, and a refined label anchored by the mark and one confident flavour name.

Hierarchy	1 MARK · 2 FLAVOUR · 3 DESCRIPTOR
Then	FUNCTION · VOLUME · BATCH
Stock	UNCOATED CREAM OR KRAFT
Finish	OPTIONAL GOLD FOIL ON THE MARK
Feel	CRAFT, PREMIUM, ALIVE

Label tone. Cream or kraft with gold and ink. Honest, uncluttered, and never more than one accent on the face.

The product

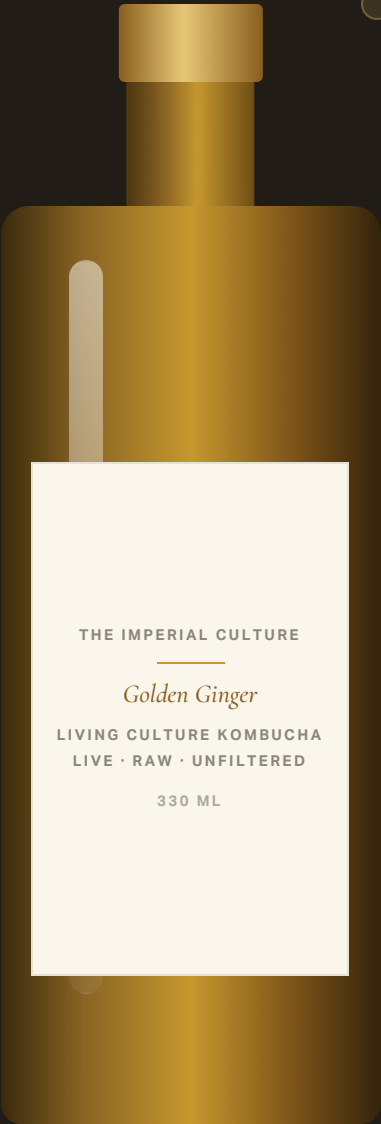
SMALL BATCH · SLOW BREWED
GENUINELY ALIVE

/ LIVING CULTURE, BOTTLED

Raise the culture.

Small batch, slow brewed, and genuinely alive.
Every bottle is a living culture kombucha,
crafted to be as good for you as it is to drink.

- LIVE CULTURES
- SMALL BATCH
- NO ADDED SUGAR



Tasting notes

THE SIGNATURE BLEND
WRITTEN IN CORMORANT ITALIC

AROMA	<i>Fresh ginger, citrus zest, green tea</i>
TASTE	<i>Bright and lightly tart, a clean finish</i>
BODY	<i>Light, crisp, naturally effervescent</i>
CULTURE	<i>Live, raw, unfiltered fermentation</i>
FUNCTION	<i>Gut friendly, low sugar, no additives</i>
PAIRS WITH	<i>Brunch, sharp cheese, a warm afternoon</i>



GOLDEN GINGER · THE SIGNATURE

Credentials

FIVE SEALS · ALL EARNED
NEVER APPLIED WITHOUT CLEARANCE

The seals we stand behind: honest markers of how The Imperial Culture is made, printed with pride on every bottle.



Each seal is a claim, and every claim is regulated. Nothing here is applied to a market until Legal (4.2) has cleared it for that market’s labelling rules.

The box tier system

FOUR TIERS · FIXED FINISHES
OCCASION SETS THE TIER

Four tiers, each with a fixed material and finish. The tier is chosen by occasion, never by budget alone: a cheaper finish on a gift tier reads as a downgrade of the whole brand.

TIER 01

Basic carrier pack

EVERYDAY MULTIPACKKRAFT & INK

TIER 02

Standard gift box

RETAIL GIFTCREAM & GOLD

TIER 03

Premium presentation crate

WOODEN CRATEFOIL & EMBOSS

TIER 04

Limited seasonal edition

COLLECTORSPECIAL FINISHES

Product architecture & naming

ARCHITECTURE MODEL

TIER 1 · CORE RANGE

Signature flavours

The everyday heroes: recommended, always available. Master brand leads, flavour supports.

TIER 2 · EDITIONS

Seasonal & limited

Special brews and collaborations that extend the world without diluting it. Always clearly badged as editions.

Master brand

ALWAYS LEADS

Flavour

SUPPORTS, NEVER REPLACES

Editions

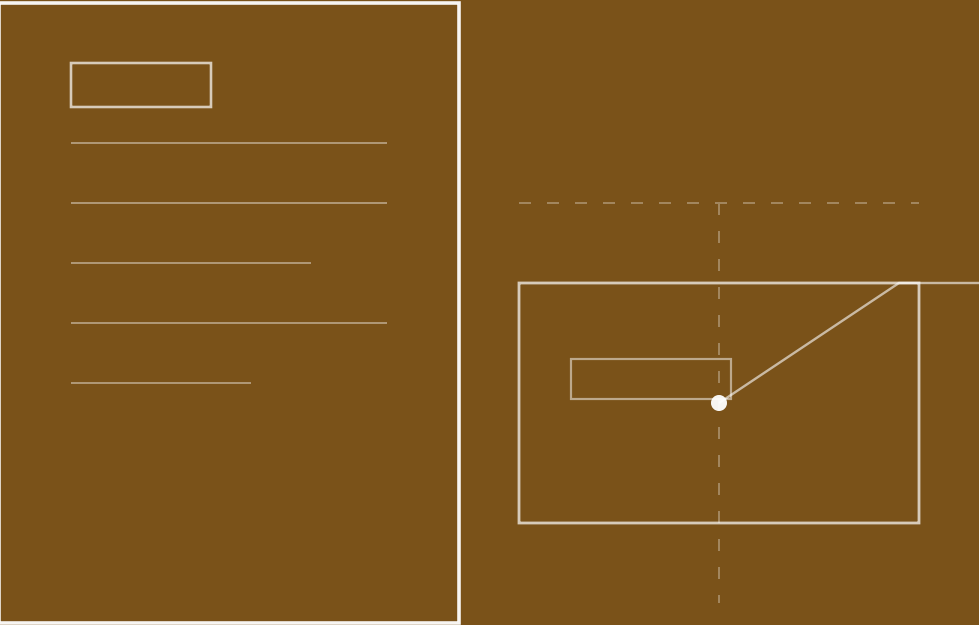
BADGED, DATED, FINITE

NAMING RULES

- ✓ Short, evocative, single or paired words (Golden Ginger, Wild Hibiscus).
- ✓ Sensory and natural: reflect the ingredient or the feeling.
- ✓ Consistent structure across the whole range.
- ✗ Clinical, medical or supplement-style names.
- ✗ Over-hyped or trend-chasing language.
- ✗ Long, complex or hard-to-say names.

House style. Two words maximum, sensory first, ingredient second: *Golden Ginger, Wild Hibiscus*. The master brand always leads the lockup; the flavour never becomes the logo.

CORPORATE & PRINT



The business face of the brand.

3.2

Stationery

RESTRAINED · TACTILE · PREMIUM
THE SAME CALM, IN PRINT



BUSINESS CARD · 90 × 54 MM

CREAM STOCK

STOCK

Uncoated, natural white or cream,
300 to 350 gsm. Tactile and warm.



LETTERHEAD · A4

HAIRLINE SYSTEM

FINISH

Optional gold foil or blind emboss on
the mark. Restraint over decoration.



ENVELOPE · DL

BRAND BLOCK SEAL

LAYOUT

Left aligned, wide margins, hairline rules. Never crowd the card.

Everyday collateral

THE SMALL TOUCHES
WHEN IN DOUBT, DO LESS

The pieces that carry the brand day to day: digital signatures, team identity, apparel, and the small touches that build recognition.



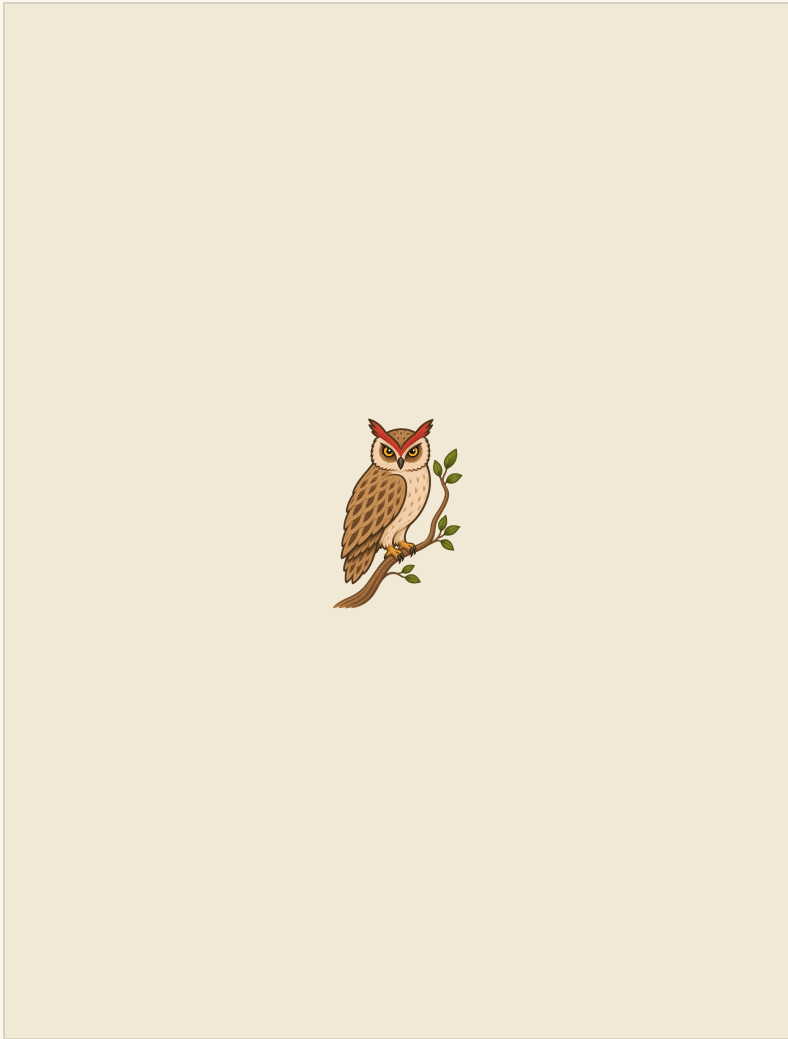
EMAIL SIGNATURE **DIGITAL**
One line, one rule, one mark



LANYARD & NAMETAG **TEAM**
Reversed mark on the amber block



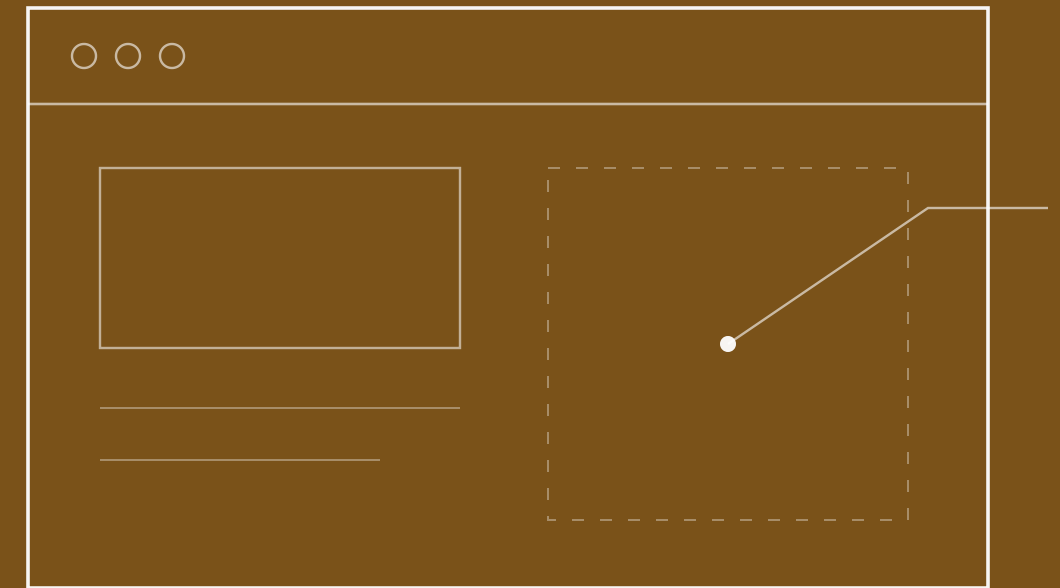
APPAREL: TEE, CAP, APRON **MERCH**
Mark only, no slogan walls



STICKERS & LABELS **EXTRAS**
The brand mark, full colour

Principle. Collateral should feel like a natural extension of the pack: one brand colour, one clear mark, plenty of space. When in doubt, do less.

MARKETING & DIGITAL



The same warmth, at scale.

3.3

Social media

THE FEED IS A COMPOSITION
RECOGNISABLE BEFORE THE CAPTION



GRID RHYTHM · 3 × 3 @THEIMPERIALCULTURE

A curated window into good living

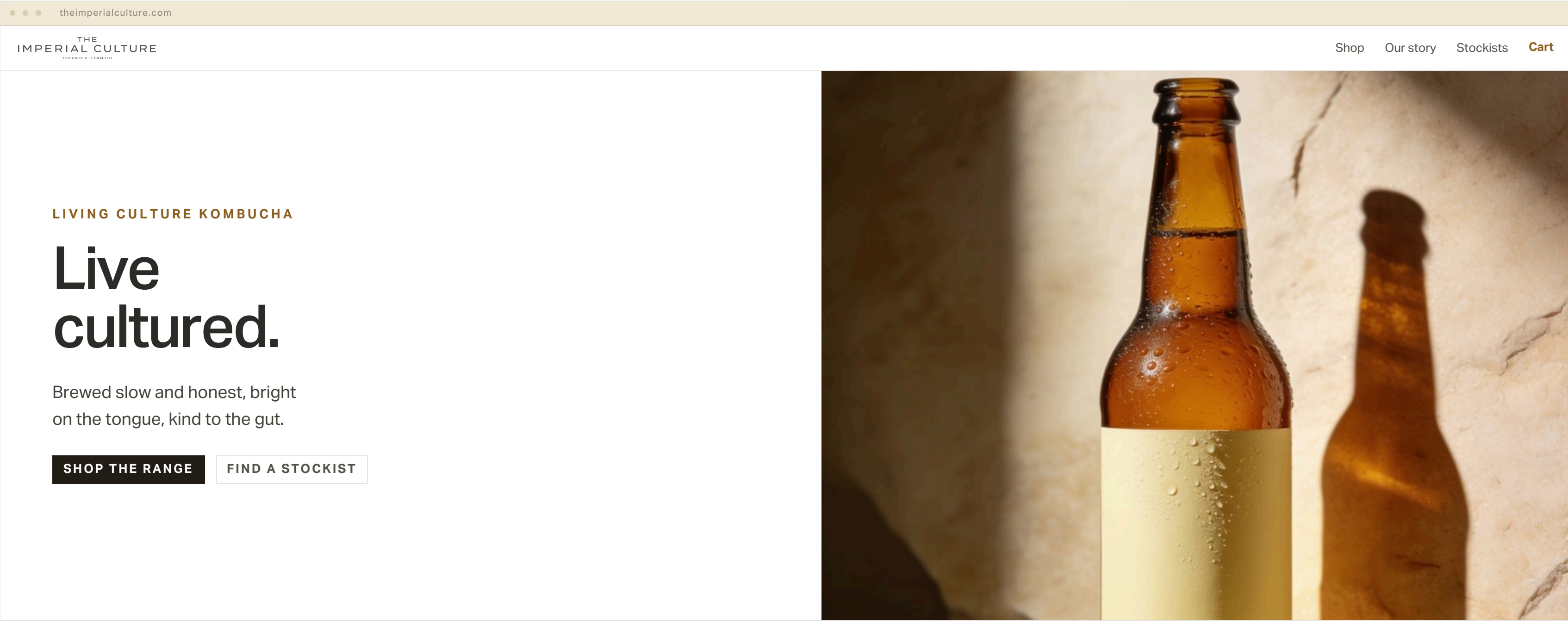
Every post should feel unmistakably ours before the caption is even read. Alternate product, lifestyle and craft so the feed breathes.

Grid rhythm	PRODUCT · LIFESTYLE · CRAFT
Consistency	WARM LIGHT · BRAND COLOUR · SPACE
Voice	WARM, WITTY, UNHURRIED
Never	DISCOUNT SHOUTING · HYPE · CLUTTER

Caption voice. Warm, witty, unhurried. Invite, never hard sell.
One idea per post, and never more than one call to action.

Website & commerce

CALM · PREMIUM · WARM
EFFORTLESS TO EXPLORE



01 · LAYOUT

Wide margins, one hero per view, generous space.

02 · TYPE

Aktiv Grotesk throughout; Cormorant italic for editorial accents.

03 · MOTION

Gentle reveals and effervescence. Nothing that hurries the reader.

04 · COMMERCE

A calm purchase path. Quality over urgency, never countdown timers.

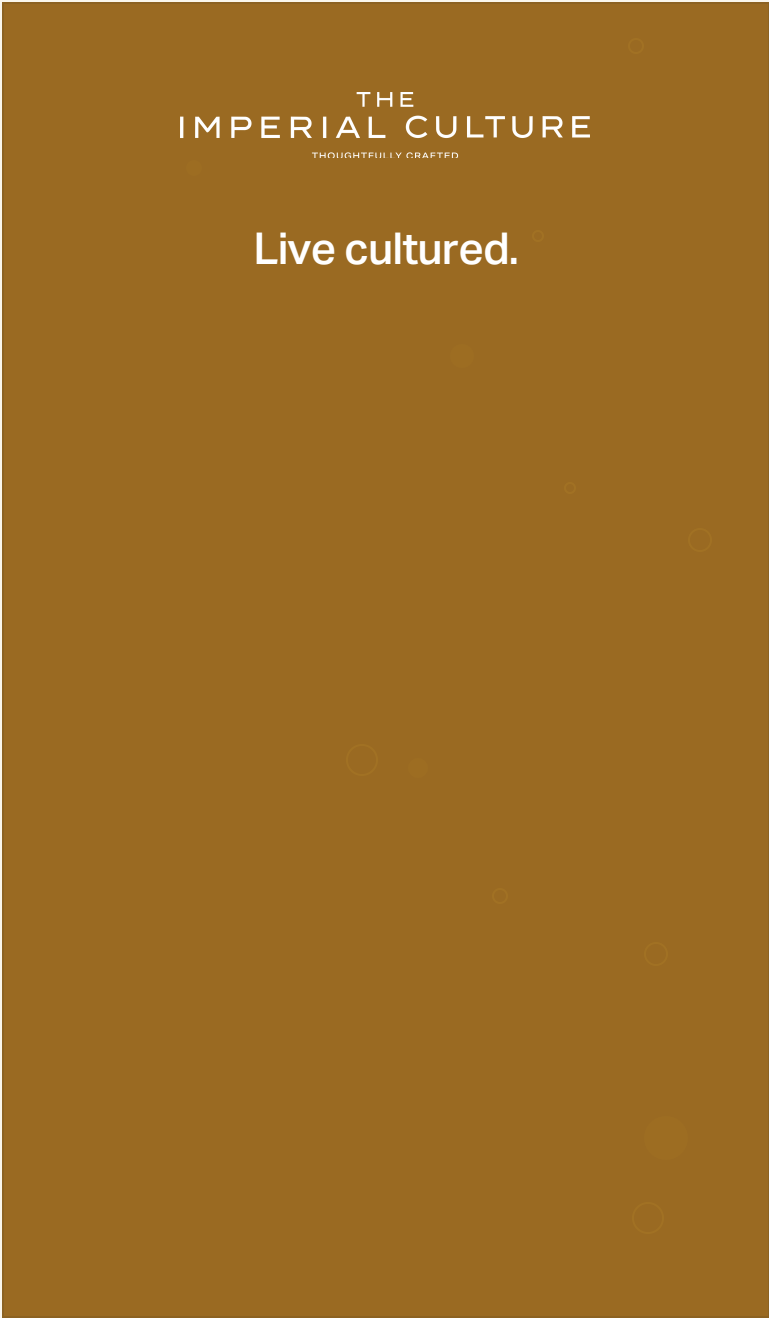
Out of home

THREE SECONDS · ONE IDEA
RESTRAINT WINS IN PUBLIC



DIGITAL BILLBOARD · 6 SHEET

ONE IMAGE, ONE LINE



FEATHER FLAG

MARK STAYS LEVEL



RETAIL ACTIVATION

SAMPLING STAND

In physical space, restraint wins. One image, one line, one mark: confident enough to hold attention without shouting. If a passer-by needs more than three seconds, the piece is too busy.

Video & motion

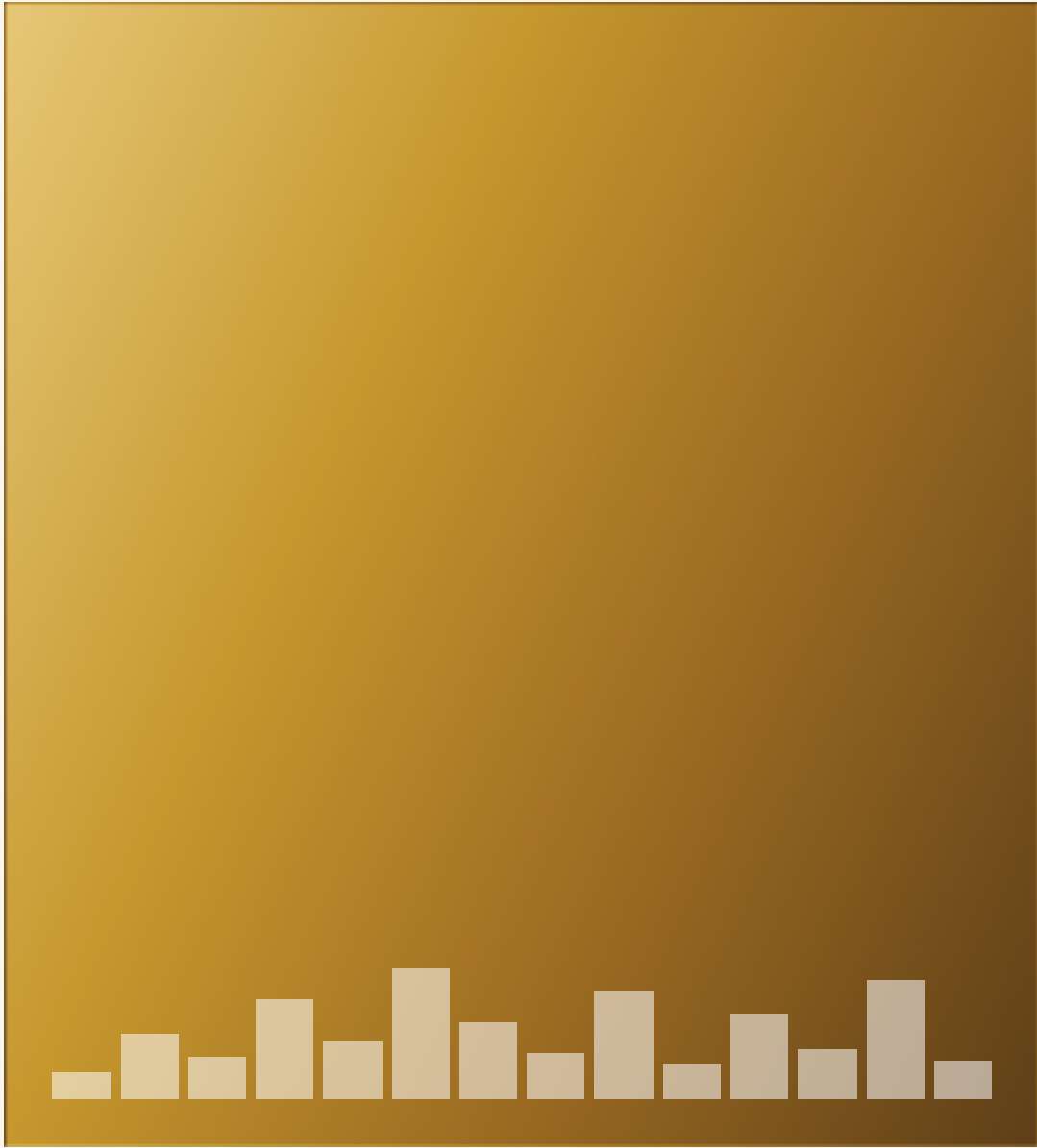
PAGE · MOTION · SOUND
THE MOTIF MOVES, THE MARK DOES NOT



01 · PACE
UNHURRIED, CINEMATIC
Let each shot breathe. Cuts land on the pour, never on the beat.



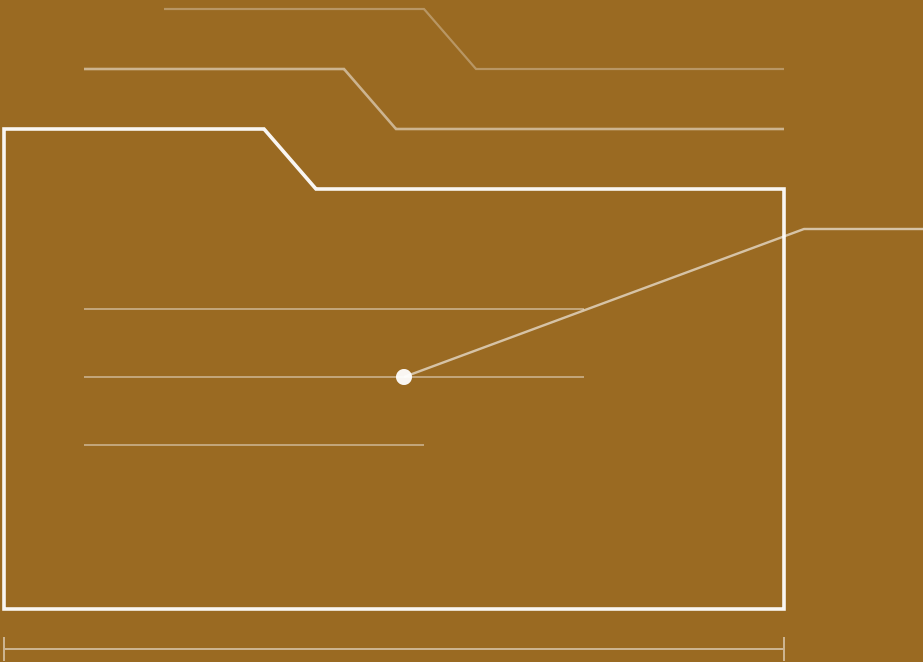
02 · SIGNATURE MOTION
RISING BUBBLES
Rising bubbles, pouring liquid, soft light shifts.
The motif animates; the logo never does.



03 · SOUND
WARM, ORGANIC, MINIMAL
A satisfying pour, a gentle fizz. No stock
music beds, no voice-over hard sell.

End frame. Every film closes on the wordmark, centred, held for a minimum of 1.5 seconds on cream or ink, followed by the tagline in Cormorant italic. Nothing else moves in the end frame.

BRAND ASSETS



4.0

What keeps the system intact as the brand grows.

Brand assets & governance

FILES, LEGAL, PROTECTION, SIGN-OFF
THE SYSTEM THAT HOLDS

4.1 Documents & file naming

The master library, the naming convention and the formats

- Asset library & file naming

4.2 Legal & compliance

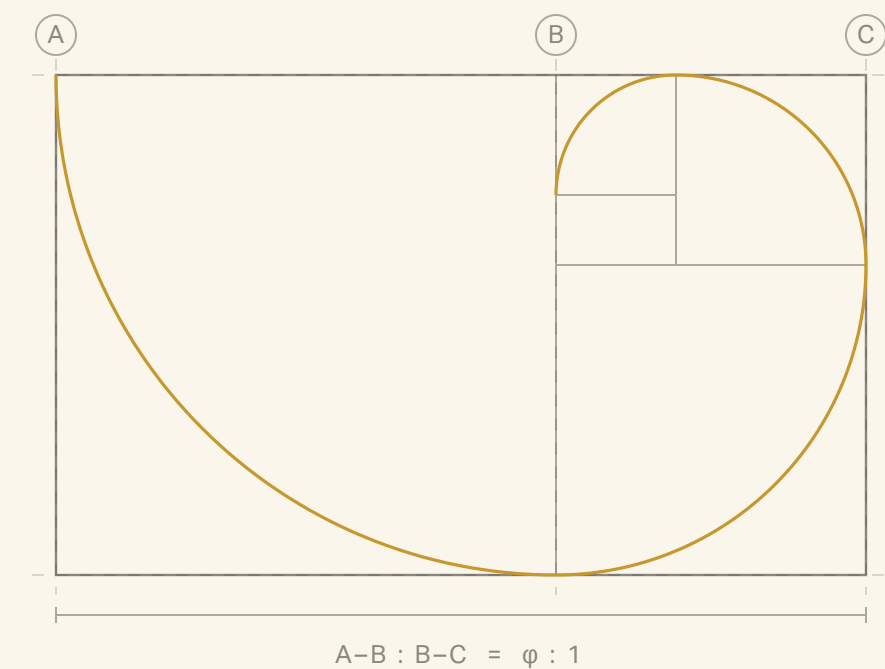
Ownership, trademark, claims and collaboration

- Legal, trademark & compliance
- Collaboration & co-branding

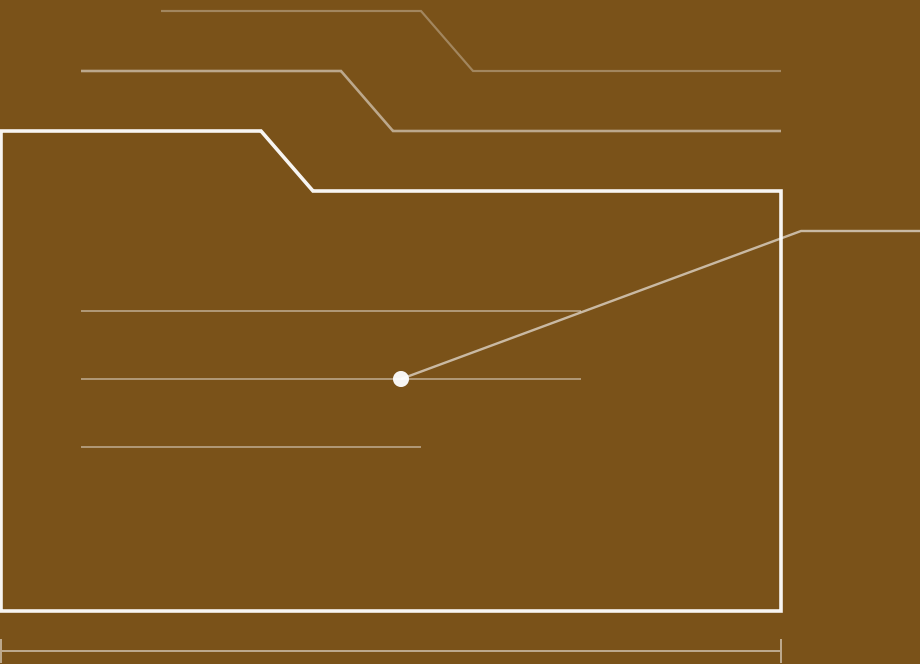
4.3 Governance & approvals

Guarding against dilution, and the path to sign-off

- Protecting against dilution
- Approvals & sign-off



THE LIBRARY



Always pull the latest approved file.

4.1

Asset library & file naming

ONE CONVENTION · SEVEN FOLDERS
NEVER RECREATE AN ASSET

THE CONVENTION

TIC_[Type]_[Variant]_[Colour]_[Version].[ext]

TIC_Logo_Primary_Gold_v1.svg
TIC_Pkg_Bottle-Label_Original_v2.pdf
TIC_Social_Grid-Quote_Cream_v3.png

Vector	.SVG / .AI · MASTER ARTWORK
Print	.PDF · CMYK, CROPS, BLEED
Screen	.PNG / .SVG · RGB
Never	.JPG OF A LOGO · SCREENSHOTS

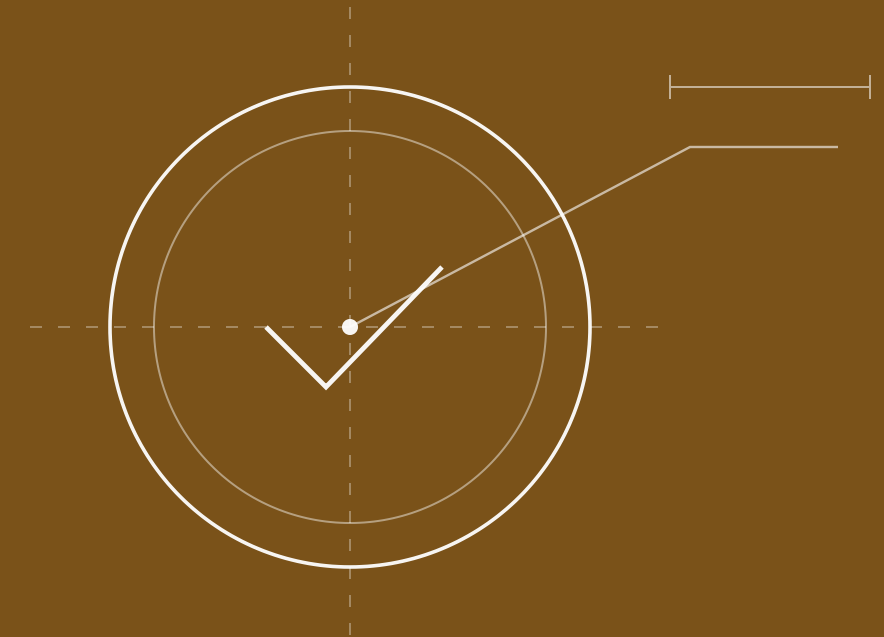
Superseded files move to **/_archive** and are never sent to a partner.
Always pull the latest approved file; never recreate a brand asset by hand.

MASTER LIBRARY

- 01 Logo & marks
- 02 Colour & type
- 03 Templates
- 04 Packaging
- 05 Photography
- 06 Social & digital
- 07 Legal & toolkit

Access. Files are issued by the brand custodian, versioned, on request. Forwarded copies are not a source of truth: if you did not receive it from the library, do not use it.

LEGAL & TRADEMARK



The protection under the whole system.

4.2

Legal, trademark & compliance

PROTECTED PROPERTY
CLAIMS CLEAR LEGAL FIRST

To preserve the integrity of The Imperial Culture, all brand elements are subject to legal protection and consistent, compliant use.

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

The name, logo, wordmark, colour system, typography and visual signatures are protected property. They may not be reproduced, altered or extended without written approval.

TRADEMARK USAGE

Use the registered mark consistently. Apply the appropriate symbol as advised by legal counsel, and never alter, redraw or recreate the mark for a single application.

COMPLIANCE

All product, health and labelling claims must meet local regulations. Route every wellness claim through legal review before publication, in every market.

Distinguish the trademark. Always use the full brand name as a distinctive brand, keep it consistent across all materials, and preserve its integrity to protect long-term brand value.

Collaboration & co-branding

THREE POSTURES · ONE STANDARD
NEITHER BRAND CROWDS THE OTHER

Partnerships extend our reach, but never at the cost of our identity. When The Imperial Culture works with others, the brand leads with clarity, warmth and equal respect.

TIC LEADS

Curated collaborations and in-house editions. The Imperial Culture name takes primary position.

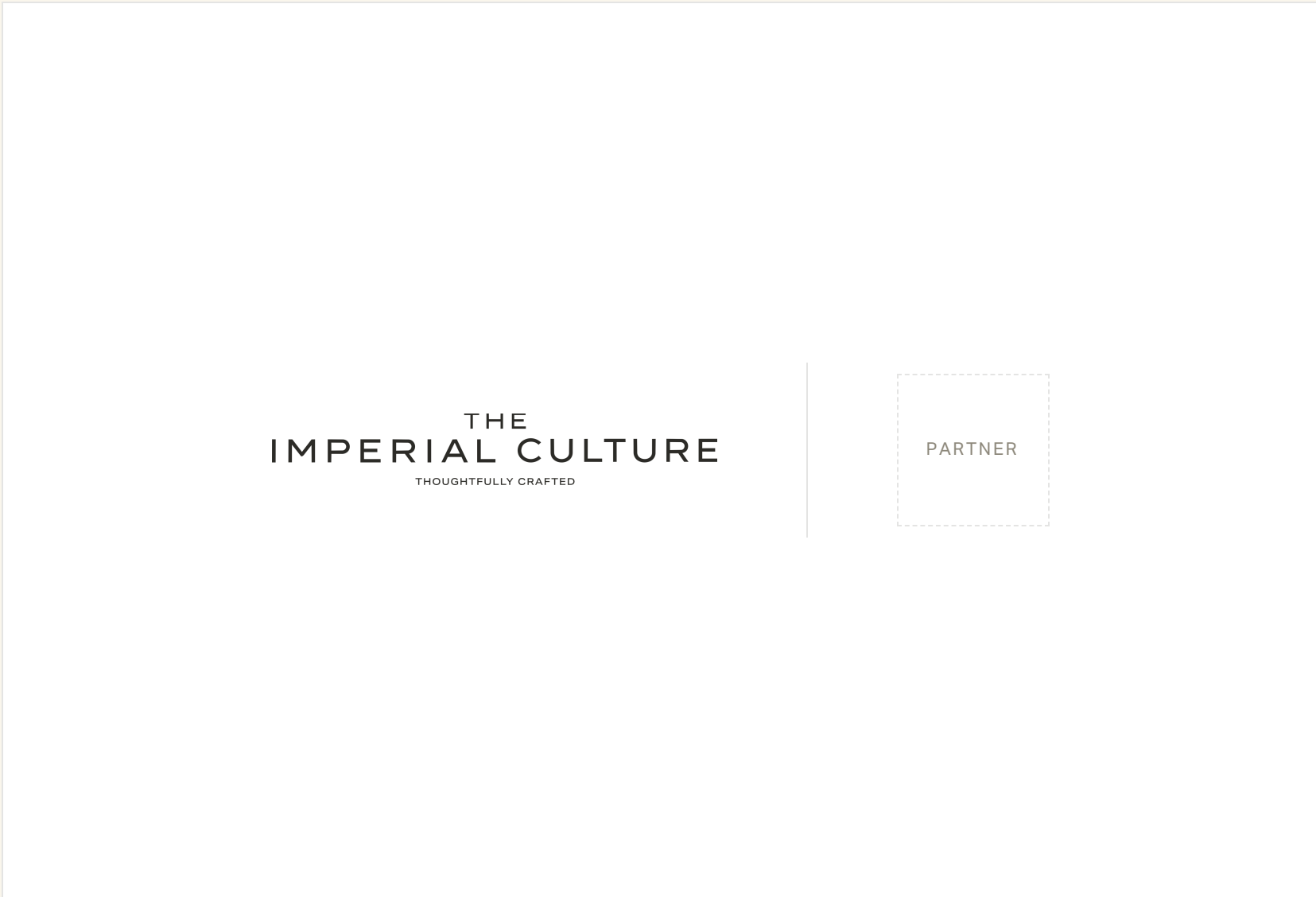
EQUAL PARTNERSHIP

Co-branded work. Clear, balanced lockups with defined spacing. Neither brand crowds the other.

NEVER

No cramped lockups, no colour compromise, no mixing of brand assets into a single mark.

THE CO-BRAND LOCKUP

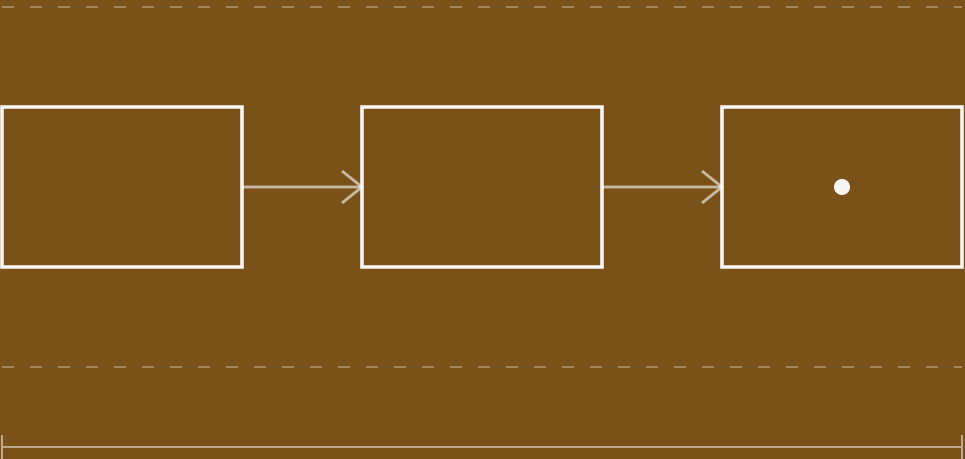


EQUAL LOCKUP · DIVIDER = X, CLEARSPACE = X EACH SIDE

APPROVED

Rule. Every partnership must protect the calm, premium character of the brand. If a collaboration would make TIC feel loud, cheap or off-tone, it is not the right partnership.

GOVERNANCE



Consistency is not negotiable.

4.3

Protecting against dilution

THREE PRINCIPLES · FIVE RISKS
DILUTION IS CUMULATIVE

CORE PRINCIPLES

- 01

Consistency over novelty
Repetition builds recognition. Resist constant reinvention.
- 02

Quality over volume
Never trade craft or premium feel for reach or speed.
- 03

Guard the tone
Avoid discount-led, hype or clinical messaging in every channel.

DILUTION RISKS TO WATCH

- ✗

Aggressive discounting and “sale” messaging.
- ✗

Off-brand colour, type or cluttered layouts.
- ✗

Cheap materials or inconsistent packaging.
- ✗

Overextending the range without structure.
- ✗

Partnerships that clash with brand values.

The custodian’s question. Not “is this on brand?” but “if we did this every week for a year, what would the brand become?”
Dilution is rarely one bad piece; it is a hundred small compromises.

Approvals & sign-off

THREE STEPS · ONE CUSTODIAN
ONLY APPROVED WORK SHIPS

This guide upholds the brand’s integrity, but it cannot cover every case. When a new application is not answered here, route it through the brand custodian before it goes live.

STEP 1

Create to guide

Match new work to the closest existing standard in this book.

STEP 2

Submit for review

Send to the brand custodian with context: channel, market, run length.

STEP 3

Approve & release

Only approved work ships, prints or publishes. No exceptions.

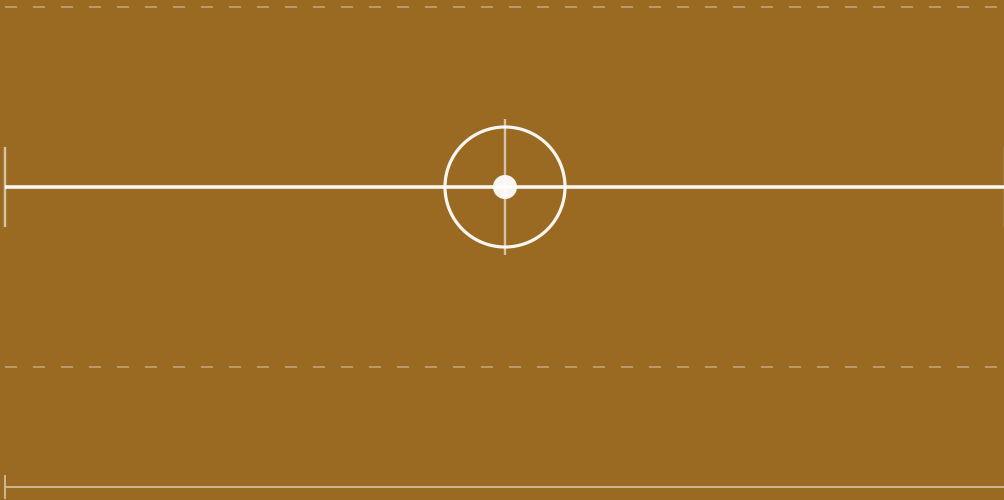
WHAT ALWAYS NEEDS SIGN-OFF

- ✓ All packaging and label artwork
 - ✓ New product names and edition badging
 - ✓ Out of home, press and paid media
- ✓ Anything carrying a health or function claim
 - ✓ Co-branded and partnership lockups
 - ✓ Any new application not covered in this book

TURNAROUND

Allow three working days for standard review, and five for anything carrying a health or regulatory claim. Rush requests are accepted, but the standard is never lowered to meet a deadline.

APPENDIX & CONTACTS



Who to ask, and what this document is.

5.0

Contacts & custodian

WHO TO ASK
BEFORE YOU PUBLISH, NOT AFTER

GET IN TOUCH

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Approvals	THREE WORKING DAYS, STANDARD
Asset requests	VIA THE BRAND CUSTODIAN ONLY

THIS DOCUMENT

Title	BRAND BOOK · MASTER
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Revisions. This book is a living document. Where a page conflicts with a newer approved decision, the record wins and the book is revised at the next version. Nothing is changed silently.

CLOSING

Thank you. Live cultured.

Thank you for helping bring The Imperial Culture to life. Every consistent, considered expression protects the trust and craft this brand is built on.

THE
IMPERIAL CULTURE
THOUGHTFULLY CRAFTED

BRAND OS V2.0 · THE IMPERIAL CULTURE

BRAND OS V2.0 · EDITION 1.0 · 2026

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Quality checked

ONE FRAME · EVERY PAGE
PRESS A, THEN G

Every page in this book was set on the same frame: 1920 × 1080, 112 px side margins, a 12 column grid with 40 px gutters, and a fixed six-step type ladder. Press **A** for the frame and **G** for the full guides to check any page against it.

FRAME

1920 × 1080 · margins 112 /
48 / 32 · content 1696 × 923

GRID

12 columns · 104.7 px each · 40
px gutters · splits 6+6, 7+5, 4+4+4

TYPE

Aktiv Grotesk 200-700 · Cormorant
Garamond editorial · six steps

COLOUR

Locked palette · 60 / 25 / 10 / 5
ratio · AA contrast on every pairing

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Good things
take culture.